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Wellington & District LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharœna, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

Established August, 2021

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Inc GST

No. 228

THURSDAY, APRIL 16, 2026

ISSN 2653-2026

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

NEXT MEETING
TUESDAY
26 MAY
Full TAB Meeting
Racing at its Best

Looking to Anzac Day - P 11

Binjang tea brews national success - P 19

Audrey's one young philanthropist - P 21

Railcrossing upgrade starts this week

WORK ON Wellington's Warne Street railway crossing began this week, but only a few people were told about it.

Transport NSW and its rail contractor UGL Regional Linx (UGLRL) had emailed council, bus companies and "key stakeholders" close to three weeks ago, but nothing to local townspeople, many of whom cross the rail line daily.

A spokesperson for TransportNSW sent the *Wellington & District Leader* a response to our enquiry after receiving a copy of that email.

The response stated "The level crossing on Warne Street in Wellington is one of 23 level crossings which are planned to be upgraded under the combined Regional Level Crossing Upgrade Fund and Level Crossing Improvement Programs.

"All upgrades include the installation of high intensity LED lights, bells, and retroreflective boom gates, with the works reducing the risk of collisions, near hits and improve safety on local and regional roads.

"This project is in the final stages of planning. Our contractor UGL Regional Linx (UGLRL) will share project information with the wider community when this is finalised."

The Wellington public would still be waiting for project information from TransportNSW if UGLRA had not taken swift action late last week while

transport department people were waiting on ministerial office approval to release and advertise information.

A two-page advertisement from UGLRL is appearing on pages 4-5 inside today's edition, giving full details of the timing and planned works at the crossing and notifying detours while the crossing is closed.

Work was to start on Monday (April 13) and through to Friday, May 1.

During the work a 1.4 kilometre detour will be in place via Warne Street, Percy Street, Gisborne Street and Simpson Street with an extended journey time, according to the advertisement, of about two minutes.

A map shows the detour route.

There will be some weekend work and one continuous shift from 10pm on April 21 to 10pm April 26 including Anzac Day.

Once the rail crossing has been upgraded, Boom Gates will be installed between June and September - and - it states the community will be notified ahead of any work.

With Blue Mountains road failures and the incredible delay in 'fixing' the Scabbing Flat Bridge at Geurie, it is no wonder communities west of the 'sandstone curtain' are losing faith with the Minns Labor Government's transport department.

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THURSDAY, APRIL 2, 2026

ISSN 2653-2026

Incredibly lucky man - P 3

Daylight Saving ends 2am Easter Sunday

Mumblebone Merinos stitch up wool deal - P7

Tell us, when?

Warne Street rail level crossing to be upgraded. But TransportNSW slow on letting locals know.

BY MARK GRIGGS

AN EMAIL forwarded to the *Wellington & District Leader* by a concerned reader a couple of weeks ago that will commence on the Warne Street level crossing on April 17 and continue to May 1 with the crossing closed for the duration.

The Leader contacted Transport NSW asking when the local community was going to be told either through departmental advertising or local media.

The reply by a Transport department spokesperson stated:-

"The level crossing on Warne Street in Wellington is one of 23 level crossings which are planned to be upgraded under the combined Regional Level Crossing Upgrade Fund and Level Crossing Improvement Programs.

"All upgrades include the installation of high intensity LED lights, bells, and retroreflective boom gates, with the works reducing the risk of collisions, near hits and improve safety on local and regional roads.

"This project is in the final stages of planning. Our contractor UGL Regional Linx (UGLRL) will share project information with the wider community when this is finalised.

The information shared to date (in the email received by the Leader) was with key stakeholders and was provided limited to local council, emergency services and local bus companies.

Community and key stakeholders will be informed of confirmed project scope, work dates and possible impact ahead of any work taking place."

It was stated that during the delivery stage of the project the community will be informed with a letter box drop, so the local Council and local Member of Parliament.

The email stated that a 1.4 kilometre detour would be in place via Warne, Percy, Gisborne and Simpson Streets with an extended journey time of two minutes.

With just two weeks off the crossing's closure for at least 14 days, begs the question when will locals be notified?

Inside this week

2026 Wellington Boot Racing Carnival highlights

- Pages 3, 10, 18, 20

Citizenship ceremony held in Wellington Civic Centre

THE LATEST list of conferees to undertake their citizenship pledge had 15 Wellington locals, so I made the decision to hold the ceremony in Wellington.

Tuesday last week a large group of friends, family and supporters gathered at the Civic Centre, along with Deputy Mayor Phillip Toynton and Federal Member for Calare, Andrew Gee MP, to celebrate the marvellous gift of Australian citizenship.

If somebody is prepared to move to our community, spend a decade or more working diligently in an area of need, pay their tax, contribute in a positive way, along with sharing our values, then it's only fair that they be awarded Australian citizenship.

Duke of Wellington Bridge update

The extremely complex and detailed design work is well underway for the repair of the approach roads to the Duke of Wellington Bridge.

Once that is completed then the job can be tendered out, with (re)construction starting soon after that. The search continues for another \$10-12 million in grant funding to build a retaining wall back along the Bell

River to protect the approach roads from future flooding.

What's on in Wellington? PLENTY!

Enjoy a great range of school activities in Wellington this school holidays.

Youth Week Friday Funday: Friday 17 April; 11am to 3pm; Kennard Park.

Enjoy an exciting obstacle course, colour run, games, music, food and connect with local youth services. These events are proudly supported by Dubbo Regional Council and local community organisations and service providers.

Wellington Library – it's all happening!!

I called into the Wellington Library on Tuesday to film a video promoting the Lego Club, and was extremely impressed with the range of services and activities provided by the amazing Library Services Team.

Not only is there the Lego Club (Tuesday during School Term time, 3.30pm-4.30pm, 5-12 year-olds) where kids can explore their creative, hands-on, building skills, but the

range of interesting books is vast.

The team at the library can assist with borrowing books for free through the State Library of New South Wales in over 40 different languages.

You can also access a great variety of magazines, newspapers, books, audio books and films in your language online for free.

Plus, Story Box Library has a collection of Auslan interpreted stories for children which is also available through Macquarie Regional Library. For more information on books in your language visit www.mrl.nsw.gov.au/learn/in-your-language

Wello Caves – Mates Rates 50% discount tickets for locals

Don't forget the Wello Caves 50% discount on entry tickets for locals. Just show your drivers licence (or similar) for proof of residency to receive the discount.

Never Bin a Battery

Batteries require special disposal as they can cause fires in domestic bins, in the back of the garbage truck, or in the tip itself.

Household batteries such as AA and AAA can be disposed of for free at a number of local sites in Wellington and Dubbo, as well as the Wellington Waste Transfer Station and the Whylandra Waste and Recycling Centre.

Embedded batteries such as vapes and headphone can be taken to Whylandra Waste and Recycling Centre and are accepted for free as part of NSW EPA's embedded battery trial. Contact Council if you have a battery disposal question - 68014000.

Council Website Refresh - Give your feedback

We're refreshing Council's corporate website to improve the experience and to plan for future development, taking into consideration both desktop and mobile views.

Your feedback will play a key role in guiding the scope and planning of the new website, ensuring it reflects the needs of our diverse community.

From the Council website you can also navigate to the survey using the pop-up, the carousel of images at the top of the home page, or in the footer of any webpage.

Josh Black

Independent's fuel price Bill defeated by major parties

Fair Fuel Price Bill Giving Federal Government Power to Set Fuel Prices rejected by Federal Labor and Coalition

A FAIR Fuel Price Bill introduced by Independent Federal Member for Calare, Andrew Gee, was voted down by the Labor government and Coalition opposition in federal parliament last week.

"Our country communities are being devastated by these sky rocketing fuel prices," Mr Gee said.

"It's smashing our local businesses and is stinging everyone from families to pensioners.

"During the Second World War, the federal Parliament passed laws which gave the Australian Government the power to set fuel prices for the duration of that conflict.

"It was aimed at preventing price gouging and proved effective.

"My Bill also gives the government the power to set fuel prices for the duration of the current conflict in the Middle East. People in the bush

have been putting up with the price gouging of country motorists for years with enormous disparities between city and country fuel prices.

"This crisis has again brought the issue of price gouging into stark relief.

"The government needs a taskforce to tell it if there's price gouging going on, but our communities do not.

"They're tired of all talk, no action. Decisive leadership is required.

"Sky high fuel prices are throttling our community members and businesses.

"Our farmers can't get the diesel they need to get their crops in the ground.

"Without action this fuel crisis could very quickly spiral into a food security crisis.

"It was extremely disappointing that none of the major parties supported the Bill.

"Sadly, once again, talk by the major parties has not been backed up by a vote in Parliament," Mr Gee said.

New title for Local Court judicial officers comes into effect

NSW MAGISTRATES are now known as judges to better reflect the nature and volume of crucial work done in the Local Court.

The State Government last year amended the Local Court Act 2007 to change the title of magistrates to judges.

According to Attorney General Michael Daley this is more than just a name change.

"It's a proper acknowledgement of the important work done in Australia's busiest court jurisdiction which hears a growing number of and increasingly complex cases each year," he said.

Over the past decade, the number of matters commenced in the Local Court have risen by a third with nearly half a million begun in 2024.

The title of magistrate is a historical one stemming from a time when judicial officers were appointed from the public service and sat in the Court of Petty Sessions.

Local Court judicial officers have been required to hold legal qualifications for more than 70 years.

NSW joins the Northern Territory's Local Court

and Federal Circuit and Family Court of Australia where the title of magistrate has been changed to judge.

The title change does not affect existing powers, functions or protections of Local Court judicial officers.

"The role of magistrates has changed significantly in recent decades, but their title hasn't kept pace with the volume and complex of matters they hear.

They perform a judicial role, and their title should reflect that.

"Judicial officers in the Local Court do the same things as their counterparts in other courts in NSW," Mr Daley said.

"Not only is there no reason not to make this change; it is absolutely deserved."



KFC staff Laiteara Sloane, Callie Ryan, Charlie Tzyan, Patrick Angell, Sian Bullock, Shia Cook.



Discussing the odds at the Bookies ring during the Wellington Boot racing carnival.

Obituaries of our loved ones are welcomed for publication in the
Wellington & District Leader

Contact: mark@wdleader.news

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

Wellington & District Leader is independently published locally by Mark Griggs and Sharon Wilson trading as Wellington District Leader, 14 Nancarrow Lane, Wellington, NSW, 2820, ABN: 26847723165 and printed by Gilgandra Newspapers, another independent and both members of CPNSW.

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Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

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2026 Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club \$200,000 Wellington Boot winner Hellenic Belle with club president Robyn Edwards, connections, jockey Braith Nock, Wellington Race Club president Peter Barton and connections during the Boot presentation. The large Boot held by Robyn Edwards was presented to owners while a smaller version was presented to the jockey and the trainers Annabel and Rob Archibald.

Wellington Boot Racing Carnival exceeds all expectations

Scone trainers top Boot performers

BY COLIN HODGES

FORMER BULL and now champion apprentice jockey Braith Nock on Sunday won the \$200,00 Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club and Golf Club -Wellington Boot (1100 metres) for the second time in three years.

In 2024 Nock won the iconic Boot on Fingers Hunter for Scone trainer Brett Cavanough and this year it was aboard the Annabel and Rob Archibald Scone trained Hellenic Belle.

Close to the lead turning for home, Hellenic Belle (\$4) broke clear and held off the late charge from Better Off Alone (Mathew Cahill, \$7) to win by over a length with Bar Jester (Coriah Keatings, \$3.70) finishing third just ahead of \$91 outsider Maryvale ridden by Clayton Gallagher for trainer Brett Robb.

Well-performed on Sydney tracks, the Bjorn Baker, Warwick Farm trained Perfumist (apprentice Liberty Smyth, \$2.90 favourite) led throughout to win the \$100,000 Peter Milling & Company-Peter Milling Memorial “Big Dance Eligibility” Wellington Cup (1700 metres) in a close finish from Green Run (Jacob Stiff, \$26) and Instead (Braith Nock, \$3.70).

Likewise, a good front running performance by the Jane Clement, Mendooran trained Chandon Star (Shannen Llewellyn, \$9.50) when beating Pride To Follow (Mikayla Weir, \$2.50 fav) and Cougars (Coriah Keatings, \$4) in the \$75,000 Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club & Golf Club Wellington Town Plate over

1100 metres.

Unwavering faith in the horse and an extreme level of perseverance by the owners, trainer and stable staff was finally rewarded when Egyptologist won the 1700m LSS Locksmith & Security Solutions Benchmark 58 Handicap.

Always possessed of abundant ability, Egyptologist was very close to a lifetime ban from racing when refusing on multiple times to enter the starting stalls before races and official barrier trials.

On best behaviour at two recent starts, Egyptologist (\$5) with an exceptionally good ride by Jake Pracey-Holmes led throughout to beat Take The Chance (Ken Dunbar, \$4.20) and Peruno (Deep Shankar, \$8) on Wellington Boot day.

Gulgong trainer Brett Thompson heaped praise on his sons Ben, Jay and Kurt who with other stable staff and jockey Jake Pracey-Holmes had worked tirelessly to get Egyptologist back to the races.

Thompson also drew attention to the owners including Wellington committee members Michael and Simone Keirle for their support and perseverance during the difficult times with Egyptologist.

Since moving to Forbes last year, Melissa Harrison has built a good reputation as a trainer and it was a nice performance by Strassman (Clayton Gallagher, \$12) when gathering in the leaders to win the 1400m Lattitude Liquor Super Maiden Plate from Forwarding (Ken Dunbar, \$18) and Miss Maverick (Mikayla Weir, \$3).

... Continued on Page 10
More Photos inside



Kevena Unwin - winner of the 2026 Wellington Boot Tooheys Guys and Dolls Challenge. She picked Boot winner Hellenic Belle.

Congratulations to the organising committee and volunteers on a successful 2026

Wellington Boot Carnival

Dugald Saunders MEMBER FOR THE DUBBO ELECTORATE

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36A Gisborne Street, Wellington

Level crossing upgrade at Warne Street, Wellington

Community Notification

April 2026



Transport for NSW acknowledges the Traditional Custodians of the lands on which we work and pays respect to Elders past and present.

On behalf of Transport for NSW, UGL Regional Linx (UGLRL) is upgrading the level crossing at Warne Street, Wellington, between **April and September 2026**.

What work are we doing?

The level crossing at Warne Street, Wellington, is an active level crossing currently equipped with signage and flashing lights. To further improve safety, boom gates will be installed as a part of the upgrade.

The work will be completed in three stages.

Stage one will involve delivering track reconditioning, resurfacing, and upgrading the pedestrian maze between **13 April 2026 and 1 May 2026**. During this work, a **1.4-kilometre detour** will be in place via Warne Street, Percy Street, Gisborne Street and Simpson Street with an extended journey time of about **two minutes**. A map of the detour is available over the page.

Stage two will involve preparation work for the installation of the boom gates, between June 2026 and September 2026.

Stage three will commission and activate the new lights, booms, and pedestrian signals during a possession in September 2026.

The community will be notified ahead of any work.

When and where will we be working?

We'll carry out this important work at Warne Street, Wellington, from **13 April 2026 to 1 May 2026**, between **7 am and 5 pm**. This will include some weekend work and one continuous shift from **10 pm on 21 April to 10 pm on 26 April 2026**.

A map of the work location is available over the page.

What will this mean for you?

UGLRL is committed to minimising the impact of work on the local community. During the work, you will notice:

- temporary closure of Warne Street, with a 1.4-kilometre detour and an extended journey time of two minutes
- continuous 24-hour work from **10 pm on 21 April to 10 pm on 26 April 2026**.
- increased vehicle movements in the area
- some noise from machinery
- lighting during night work between 21 April and 26 April.

Managing our impacts

UGLRL will take all necessary steps to minimise community and environmental impacts. This includes, but is not limited to:

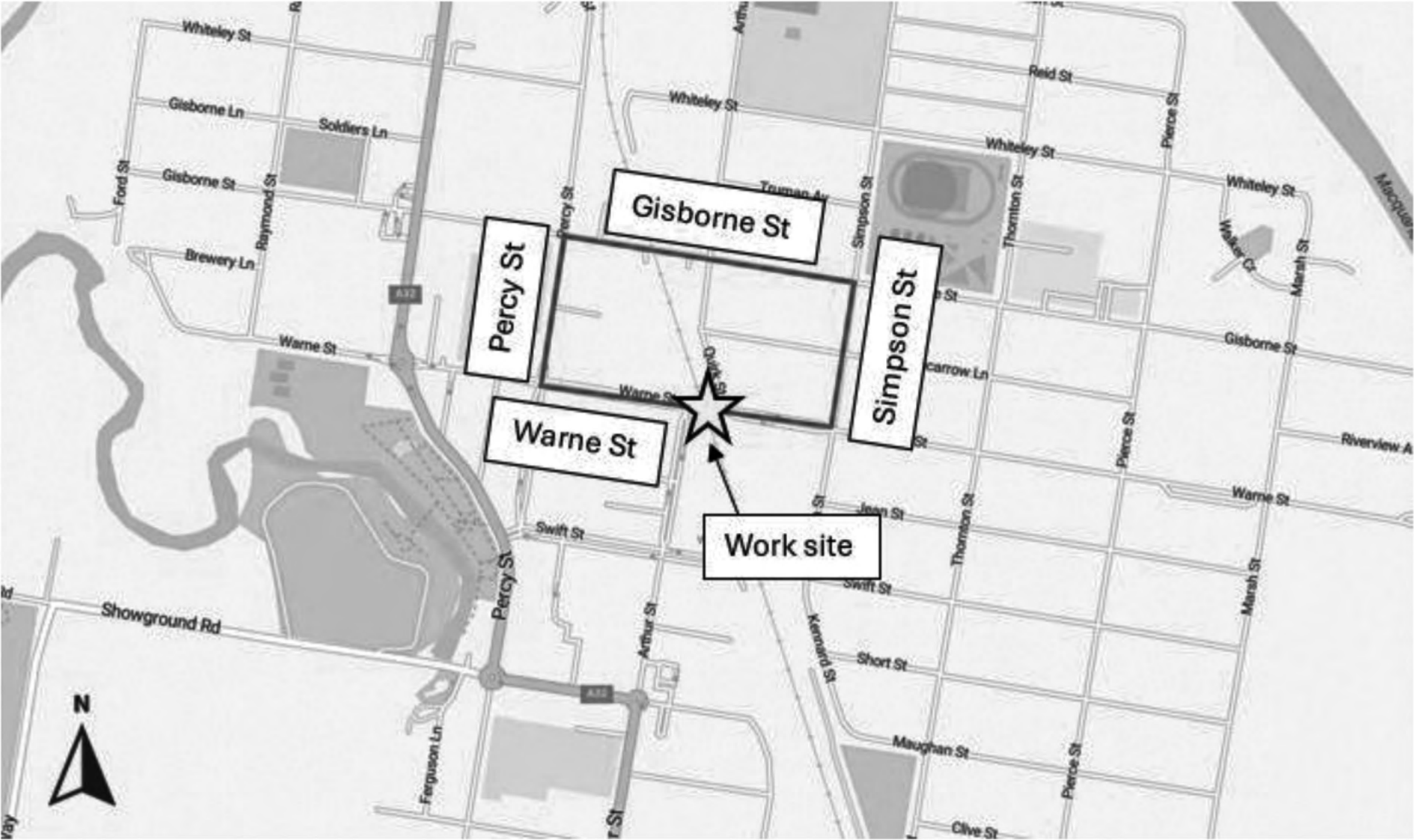
- turning off machinery when not in use
- instructing workers to keep noise to a minimum
- servicing machinery to reduce noise and environmental impact
- lighting will be pointed down towards the work site and away from residents.

Why we are doing this work

The Australian and NSW governments are jointly funding the upgrade of the Warne Street level crossing through the Australian Government's Regional Level Crossing Upgrade Fund (RLCUF) and the NSW Level Crossing Improvement Program (LCIP). Together, these programs will upgrade twenty-three high-priority level crossings in regional areas with high-intensity LED lights, bells, and retro-reflective boom gates to improve safety and reduce the risk of collisions and near hits.

Site Location and Detour

The yellow star identifies the worksite. The red line indicates the 1.4-kilometre detour in place from **13 April 2026** to **1 May 2026**, via Warne Street, Percy Steet, Gisborne Street and Simpson Street, with an extended journey time of about two minutes.



More Information

UGLRL prioritises working closely with the local community. If you have any questions or are likely to be affected by this work, please contact the Communications Team and provide your location.

Contact us



Project Infoline
1300 661 390



enquiry@uglregionallinx.com.au



<https://www.transport.nsw.gov.au/projects/current-projects/regional-level-crossing-upgrade-fund>



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Andrew GEE MP
INDEPENDENT FEDERAL
MEMBER FOR CALARE

Your True Country
Independent



RUNS ON THE
BOARD FOR
WELLINGTON

- ✓ \$9.5 million for Maranatha House Aged Care
- ✓ Introduced Bill into Parliament to ban foreign buying of residential property for two years. The Coalition and the Labor Party voted against it and then they both announced it as their policy!
- ✓ Backed Independents' Bill to reduce dominance of big supermarkets. All major parties voted against it and then Coalition announced it as their policy!
- ✓ \$50 million for storm and flood recovery in the Central West
- ✓ Secured the Parliamentary Inquiry into the Disaster
- ✓ Response of Insurers \$2 billion for Great Western Highway upgrade
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ 60 mobile phone towers and base stations for Calare
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at
- ✓ Wellington's Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

NEED FOR NATIONAL
FUEL SOVEREIGNTY



The conflict in the middle east has once again exposed Australia's vulnerability in our fuel and fertiliser supply chains.

In recent years our ability to source and manufacture fuel and to make fertiliser in Australia has been gradually degraded to the

extent that only 20% of our fuel is refined in Australia and 85% of our fertiliser is imported.

These are national security issues, and the federal government needs to learn the lessons of this crisis to ensure that we have sovereign fuel and fertiliser capability.

This means sourcing and refining fuel in Australia and manufacturing fertiliser here as well.

There is also an urgent need for fuel price controls.

I recently introduced into Parliament my Fair Fuel Price Bill which would enable the federal government to set and control fuel prices as it did in World War Two.

It was effective then and it can be effective now. It would stamp out the price gouging and the ripoffs which we all know are occurring.

Unbelievably when it was put to a vote neither

Labor, Liberals, Nationals or One Nation supported it.

With no end in sight to this conflict I intend to once again introduce my Fair Fuel Price Bill into Parliament and will keep doing so until the major parties see common sense.

The Government's multi-million-dollar advertising campaign telling Australians to save fuel by removing roof racks and pumping up tyres would be laughable if it wasn't so serious. I suggest that the Government spend a little less time on glossy and wasteful advertising and a lot more time on sovereign fuel and fertiliser capability and working on genuine solutions that control fuel prices like my Fair Fuel Price Bill.

Watch my Fair Fuel Price bill hit Parliament via the QR code here



I had a great day in Wellington last week visiting community owned and operated Maranatha House to drop off some new flags and catch up with the team.

This facility is a community not-for-profit growing from strength to strength, which is a wonderful achievement for a community-owned organisation. It was a pleasure to catch up with CEO Aejaz Adil and the legendary Linda Sarsfield, who has been a pillar of the team here for years. Aejaz also showed me the impressive new landscaping and the site for the upcoming water feature. It's already looking fantastic and will only get better as the trees and gardens establish. Congratulations to the entire Maranatha team for everything you do for the Wellington community!

As seen on my Facebook



MARANATHA
HOUSE
THRIVING



ORANGE ELECTORATE OFFICE

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Orange NSW 2800

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For regular updates and news,
follow me on Facebook and
Instagram @andrewgeecalare



Authorised by Andrew Gee MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

*Your True Country
Independent*



WELLINGTON WELCOMES ITS NEWEST AUSSIES!

It was wonderful to welcome 15 people who officially became our newest Australian citizens right here in Wellington last week!

It was a joy to see such a diverse group taking this life-changing step, including a fantastic contingent from the Philippines and even a new Aussie all the way from Texas!

These new citizens are already making important impact in our community - working in vital roles like aged care and running local businesses that employ our own local people.

While the day officially marked the start of a new chapter in their lives, their contribution to our region is already being felt.

I was honoured to join Mayor Josh Black to celebrate the rich cultures that make the Central West such a great place to live.

To our 15 newest Aussies: congratulations! We are so proud to have you as part of the Australian family.



BUSINESSES SMASHED:

THE HUMAN COST OF HIGHWAY CHAOS

Last week, I stood with the owner of a local haulage business that's been serving our region for 28 years.

The closure of Victoria Pass is a financial disaster for our transport industry and businesses around our region. For this company, the dangerous detour adds 2 hours per round trip, increases payroll taxes and has seen his fuel bill increase by \$6,000 a week.

Before Easter, I raised the concerns of our local businesses directly to the Prime Minister in Parliament. Our people have put everything on the line to keep their doors open and their staff employed, yet the government continues to sit on its hands.

We don't need more press conferences with no plans.

Lives and livelihoods are at stake. It's time the governments stepped up for a support package for a disaster caused by their own neglect.

Watch my interview via the QR code here



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Authorised by Andrew Gee MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

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Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
6pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

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LEADER

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Around the electorate with our State Member Dugald Saunders



Sports grants announced
FOUR SPORTING clubs in the Dubbo electorate are set to benefit from funds through the Local Sport Grant Program.
With the aim of increasing regular and on-going participation opportunities for their members and the wider community, this grant will allow Dubbo Kart Club and Narromine Soccer Club to purchase new equipment, while Dubbo Basketball Association will use their funds for their junior development program. Narromine Tennis Club hasn’t wasted any time with its grant for a new hit up wall, with construction already well underway.
Well-done to these four Clubs on securing these funds to support increased sporting opportunities in our region!

AED Grants announced
A further four more sporting clubs in the Dubbo electorate will also be able to purchase life-saving Automated External Defibrillators (AEDs) thanks to the Local Sport Defibrillator Grant Program.
Congratulations to Wellington Amateur

Swimming Club, Gulgong and District Pony Club, Riding for the Disabled Association Mudgee and Connecting Community Services (Orana Gymnastics Academy) on your success.

Community Consultation Day
You’re invited to join me and the Federal Member for Parkes, Jamie Chaffey MP, at the Dubbo Farmers Market on Saturday 18 April. We’ll be there from 8am until 11am to chat about what matters to you.
Come along and say g’day.

IPTAAS Fuel subsidy call
The NSW Nationals and Liberal Coalition are calling on the Minns Labor Government to boost the current 40c/km fuel subsidy for patients accessing the Isolated Patients Travel and Accommodation Assistance Scheme (IPTAAS).
With fuel prices remaining high, the cost of getting to medical appointments is becoming a serious financial burden for individuals and families, and the current IPTAAS kilometre rate is no longer keeping pace with the real

cost of travel.
Increasing the kilometre rate is a straightforward, practical step the government could take to deliver immediate, direct and tangible relief to patients and families in the regions.
There’s a real risk that people will delay or skip medical appointments because they simply can’t afford the trip.
Access to healthcare should never depend on your postcode or your ability to pay for fuel.

Basin education series
Heard about the Murray-Darling Basin Plan, but not sure what it’s all about?
The good news is the Inspector-General of Water Compliance has put together an education series detailing everything you need to know about one of Australia’s largest and most important river systems.
From the geography and history of the Murray-Darling Basin to the background of water management and the creation of the Plan, the 8-part series dives into the challenges faced by the Basin and its communities.

Check it out at:
<https://www.igwc.gov.au/get-involved/education-series>

Protect your fuel
The NSW Police Rural Crime Prevention Team is advising farmers and landholders to ‘Lock it. Move it. Watch it. Protect it.’ to help prevent fuel theft.
Some of the best ways to protect yourself from fuel theft includes locking your fuel bowser, not leaving farm machinery out in the paddock, maintaining records of deliveries and fuel usage, keeping mobile fuel tanks in line of sight of the farmhouse and, if you can, strategically placing surveillance cameras around your fuel tanks.
If you are a victim of fuel theft or notice any suspicious behaviour, report it immediately by calling your local police station or Crime Stoppers on 1800 333 000.
Remember, if police don’t know about the crime, they can’t act to reduce the crime - so work with police to stop thieves.

Until next time, Dugald

Hydrogen Aviation testing happening at Wellington aerodrome

Highway update: still no end date

LIQUID HYDROGEN will be used at the Wellington Aerodrome following approval by Council. This will allow AMSL Aero to continue testing its Vertiia test vehicle, supporting the development of hydrogen-powered aircraft designed to deliver long-range, zero emission flight.

AMSL Aero has been undertaking on-the-ground testing at the Wellington Aerodrome of their hydrogen-electric vertical take-off and landing (eVTOL) aircraft, which has been designed to take off like a helicopter and transition to efficient wing-borne flight.

Council’s airport strategy and operation manager Matthew Linsley-Noakes said the decision showed Council was committed to supporting innovation and attracting emerging technologies to the region.

“This region is embracing its status as an outdoor test and evaluation hub for companies such as AMSL Aero and playing an important role in advancing our aviation industry,” he said.

“Supporting the next phase of hydrogen aviation testing at Wellington Aerodrome shows our commitment to regional innovation and to creating opportunities for high-tech in-

dustries.”

AMSL Aero CEO Dr Adriano Di Pietro said the decision allowed them to conduct further on-the-ground testing and operational evaluations associated with liquid hydrogen fuel systems.

“The ongoing partnership between Council and AMSL Aero highlights the role regional aerodromes can play in supporting the development of next-generation aviation technologies,” he said.

“Projects like this demonstrate how regional infrastructure can support cutting-edge research and development while bringing new opportunities, investment and highly skilled jobs to regional communities.”

The project received funding from the Australian Renewable Energy Agency (ARENA) as part of ARENA’s Advancing Renewables Program.

Wellington Aerodrome is a hub for aerospace testing, training and aviation activities, supporting both recreational aviation and emerging aviation technologies.

BELOW: Recharging Vertiia with hydrogen at Wellington Aerodrome.



LAST WEEK we heard from the NSW Government regarding the Great Western Highway closure at Victoria Pass.

Unsurprisingly the investigation has confirmed the 200-year-old fill underneath the road has deteriorated significantly, resulting in gaps and voids in the structure.

With more “expert” meetings in pipeline, we are still a long way from a firm solution, let alone tendering and any construction actually starting.

This just means more uncertainty and chaos for our businesses, our families, and our local economy.

My message to the government is clear: GIVE US AN HONEST TIMELINE:

Our communities can’t wait “indefinitely.”

We need some straight talking on when this road will reopen, not endless meetings and vague timelines.

Buckle up for forever roadworks. It will be years.

SUPPORT OUR BUSINESSES:

Local businesses are being smashed by this closure.

Where is the financial support package to keep them afloat?

This whole thing was caused by government negligence.

INVEST IN THE FUTURE:

Patching up a convict bridge from 1832 isn’t enough.

We need real, high-speed access in and out of the Central West, not more “forever roadworks.”

The people of our region are not second-class citizens. It’s time the governments stopped the talk and started the work.

Sydney has just opened a new \$2 billion expressway and now they’re spruiking high speed rail that could cost over \$90 billion.

The injustice and inequality is infuriating.

GRANT OPPORTUNITIES

Supporting farmers facing hardship

The Federal Government has introduced a new Drought Hardship Loan designed to help with short-term operating costs as farmers face longer-term droughts.

The loan will enable farmers who have been affected by drought for at least 24 months and expect to be impacted for another season, to borrow up to \$250,000.

The loan duration will be five years, with interest incurred, but repayments fully deferred for the first two years.

To extend relief to existing RIC loan customers, interest rates on existing RIC loans will be held at 5.18% for another six months from 1st February, 2026.

The new Drought Hardship Loan is delivered through the Regional Investment Corporation and



The Gee Report

Andrew Gee
Federal Member for Calare



It’s not often Andrew drives his favourite possession through Wellington, but we caught up recently.

you can register your interest at <https://www.ric.gov.au/new-loans>

Arts Outwest cultural fund microgrants

Grants of up to \$1000 for individuals and \$2500 for groups are now open to support local arts and heritage projects across the Central West.

Applications close: 5pm, Monday 20 April 2026.

For further information go to: <https://artsoutwest.org.au/>

NSW GOVERNMENT VENUE UPGRADE GRANTS

Venues that demonstrate a commitment to increasing live music programming may apply for grants to support advice from consultants and experts to create fit-for-purpose venues.

For further information go to: <https://www.nsw.gov.au/grants-and-funding>

CLUBGRANTS

Local community groups, sporting clubs and charities can apply for funding through the Club-GRANTS program:

Mudgee: closes 30th April 2026

Wellington: closes 31st May 2026

For further information go to: <https://www.club-grants.com.au/>



with **Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld**

I WAS in a café recently when I accidentally found myself shoulder surfing – watching someone try to log into their account on a web site.

What followed was a familiar modern ritual: typing a password, sighing, clicking “forgot password”, checking their phone, inventing a new password with at least one capital letter, a symbol, and – presumably - a small sacrifice to the digital gods.

We’ve all been there.

For decades now, passwords have been the keys to our digital lives. And like physical keys, we’ve accumulated far too many of them - except these ones must be memorised, constantly updated, and never reused.

The advice is relentless: don’t write them down, don’t reuse them, make them long, make them complex. And apparently sticking Post-it notes on your monitor is not best practice!

Which is why you may have noticed a new option appearing lately: “Use a passkey instead.”

It sounds simple, almost suspiciously so.

No password? No memorising?

Naturally, the first question many people ask is: what’s the catch?

A passkey is designed to replace your password entirely. Instead of something you have to remember, it relies on something you already have - your device.

When you create a passkey, your phone, tablet, or computer generates two linked digital keys. One is shared with the website. The other stays securely on your device.

When you log in later, the website asks your device to prove it has the matching key, and your device confirms this using something simple like your fingerprint, face recognition, or a PIN.

No password is typed. In fact, no password exists. Behind the scenes, this uses a security method called public-key cryptography.

It is more secure because passwords can be stolen, guessed, or tricked out of you through phishing scams.

A passkey can’t be casually copied because the important part never leaves your device. Even if a company’s database is hacked,

there’s nothing useful for attackers to take. And because your device checks that it’s talking to a legitimate website, those fake login pages become far less effective.

I can hear your next question: what happens when you get a new phone or laptop?

It’s a fair concern. If your “key” lives on your device, upgrading sounds like it could lock you out of your own accounts.

Fortunately, the reality is much smoother than it sounds.

In most cases, passkeys are not tied to just one physical device - they’re synced securely through your account.

If you use a cloud-based ecosystem on your phone or computer, your passkeys are typically backed up and transferred automatically when you set up a new device.

If you’re moving between different types of devices, there are also ways to sign in using a nearby trusted device. For example, you might use your phone to approve a login on a new laptop.

Of course, there are still fallback options. Many services allow you to set up multiple

passkeys across different devices, or provide recovery methods if you lose access altogether.

What’s really happening here is a shift in how we think about security.

Passwords rely on memory, and humans are notoriously bad at that. Passkeys rely on possession - your device - and a quick confirmation that it’s really you.

It’s simpler, faster, and crucially, harder to fake.

We are, in many ways, watching the beginning of the end for the password - a technology that has served us well but is increasingly out of step with modern life.

The future of logging in won’t involve remembering strings of characters, but simply proving you are who you say you are.

I am feeling generous this year! Send a question or comment about this article to ask@techtalk.digital and the first 10 e-mails will receive a FREE Tech Talk compilation book! Get curious, get involved, get a freebie!

2026 Wellington Boot Carnival exceeds all expectations

... From Page 3

Under the expert guidance of Dubbo jockey Ken Dunbar, the Michael Lynch, Cowra trained Bounding Bon (\$15) swept home along the rails to account for Jamacri (Jacob Stiff, \$8.50) and Chappolicious (Braith Nock, \$2 fav) in the 1100m Cleanpeak Energy Country Magic Class 1 Showcase Handicap.

The other winners on Boot day were Hanuman (Braith Nock, \$1.95 fav) trained by Mack Griffith and Denman Force (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$7) trained by Brett Thompson.

Friday’s feature

First day (Friday) of the very successful Wellington Boot Carnival featured the 2400 metres Over The Line Racing-Iron Horse for stayers, won by the Ross Lomax, Mudgee trained Blazing Guru.

Ross Lomax is a noted trainer of horses racing over longer distances and a very fit Blazing Guru (Zac Wadick, \$3.90 equal favourite) after taking a slender lead at the top of the straight held on strongly to win from Williams To Excel (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$3.90) and Tavijewej (Jordan Quince, \$10).

Wellington will next race on Tuesday, May 26.

Orange Cup on Friday followed on Saturday by Tomingley Picnics and Dubbo Queen of The West meeting.

Lost perfume bottle omen for winning bet on Boot day

TUROSS HEAD local Glenda Wood enquired at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club Boot sponsors table during Sunday afternoon if anyone had seen or found her perfume bottle.

Her husband, Rex, picked up the day’s racebook and commented that a horse named Perfumist was the top-weight in the next race - R6 the Peter Milling Memorial Wellington Cup.

Well, what an omen for Glenda as she placed a bet on Perfumist and collected a nice return as the horse’s win paid \$2.90 as favourite.



Denise and George Lewis, June and Ray Drew, Kathy Kay and Collin Dillion, Gwenda and Peter Jackson in their Wellington Boot gear. The ladies wore red and the bloke’s hats were also red.



Mark Stanford celebrating his 70th birthday with family and friends on Boot Day.



Maddy Austin, Tahnee Frappell and Kaleah Austin.



Enjoying the Boot in the Sponsors tent.



Wellington Soldiers Club guests.



Guys and Dolls Challengers Ben Hessessey, Shawn Graham, Beck Maher and Alix Thornhill found out about the Challenge in the Sunday Telegraph. - The power of the press.



Bogan Gate warhorse conquered India

MACQUARIE, one of the horses ridden by Nat Barton during the First World War, was to survive.

An article written by the late Gene Makin, a journalist with The Land Newspaper decades ago, tells of his destiny.

This is the story of how a horse called Macquarie from Bogan Gate in Central NSW, became a ‘star’ on the racetracks of India.

MACQUARIE WAS one of the thousands of Australian ‘whalers’ who carried the Australian Light Horse in Gallipoli.

Since the first seven horses landed on these shores with the First Fleet in 1788, horses have played an important role in our community.

After a shipment of good quality breeding mares arrived on the ‘Britannia’ from the Cape of Good Hope in 1795, they were mated with our first imported English

Thoroughbred stallion, Rockingham who arrived here in 1799.

Daughters produced from these matings with the Cape mares were the foundation stock of the future.

One of the most famous of these was Myrtle.

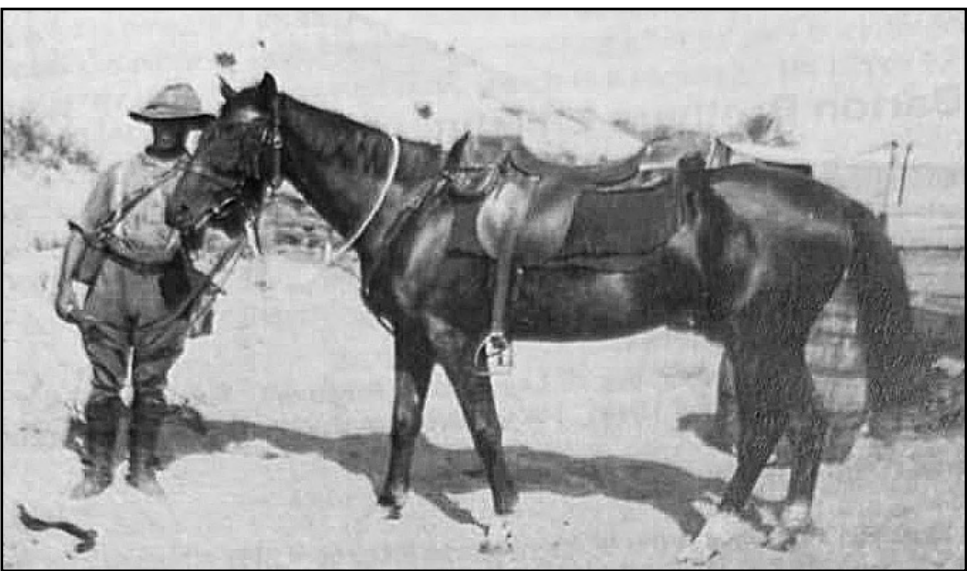
The ensuing years was infusions of Arabs and Persians and Irish Thoroughbreds.

The progeny were used to pioneer this country, crossing the mountain ranges and opening up the remote areas beyond.

In the early 1800’s the Australian bushman and bushranger and his horse were a legend which eventually became glorified on the sands of Gallipoli by the Australian Light Horse.

One such young Australian, Eric Magill of Bogan Gate and his horse Macquarie, were just one of those thousands of the brave combinations.

When Corporal Magill, whose family were heavily involved in racehorses, enlisted in the Light Horse he purchased Macquarie from the Coombes family of



Warhorse Macquarie, possibly held by his owner Corporal Eric Magill of Bogan Gate.

Bogan Gate to take with him.

But the deal was subject to a promise that Macquarie would never race.

The Coombes were strict Methodists and frowned on the ‘sport of Kings’.

In 1915 Corporal Magill sailed for active service with his horse Macquarie after being paid the princely sum of £40 by the Australian Government for his contribution of a mount.

Unfortunately, young Magill was wounded on Gallipoli while waiting for

sick leave, and died later in Malta.

His Major, Dr. N.D. Barton of Wellington acquired Macquarie and rode him until the end of the war.

With the skirmish over, there were not many options left open to the loyal war horse.

He could be shot or sold to the Egyptians. Major Barton would not agree to these suggestions. He sold him to the Indian Army where Macquarie became a assword on the Indian track.

A diary of the Great War

As written by John Hodgksin Randell (1 Light Horse Regiment) Aged 27

I ENLISTED July 21, 1915, joined July 23, went into camp July 24 at Liverpool.

Went on final leave September 30 and sailed on SS Mashbora October 4, 1915, arrived Port Suez and reached camp at Heliopolis November 7.

Went to hospital with mumps January 11, 1916. Discharged January 30.

Went to hospital with influenza February 4, discharged February 15.

March 19 went to Minceh, upper Egypt, 20 to Naylet-el-abu. Went to Kantara May 12, then Hill 70 May 13.

To Romani May 19, on the 21st we have done a 24 hour stunt. Then every other day out stunting.

June 1 a German aeroplane bombed and machine gunned our camps, unleashed 38 horses, 1 Officer and 7 men killed and 10 wounded.

2nd to 9th more stunting, on 10th to Sagu. 11 we had a slight engagement, 15th to Nogratena, 22nd to Siralabab (maybe Sira), 23 to ber-el-abd and further into Turkish country and rescued one of our planes that had met with an accident. 24th back to Romani.

More stunts with a few casualties up to August 3. The nights of 3rd, 4th and 5th we were engaged in the Battle of Romani. My mate, Mick Tuckey, was killed on the morning of August 4, 1916.

We had a couple of days spell, then we went back to Birelabd and had another engagement, we lost a good number of men and horses.

I was wounded and rode back 20 miles to rail head. On 10th I went to Kantara, on 11th to No 3 A G Hospital, Cairo. Discharged on 22nd to Convalescent Hospital at Montayah. Discharged to Base Details September 6th, 1916.

Sent back to hospital on 8th with muscular rheumatism, discharged to Montayab on 26th, discharged to bade details on October 9.

Went to School of Instruction October 26. Went to Kantara November 20, then to Odd-elgeb November 22 and joined my unit then to Arnusie November 24 and Geratt December 2.

Captured El Arish December 21. Captured Magdhaba December 23, returned to camp on December 24.

On 26th we went on a two-day stunt to Sobage , went to Rafah and captured it on January 9, 1917, then to Kanunas. Left again on 15th for Shayal, then on 18th for Urke.

On 19th we had a big engagement. I was wounded and left for rail head to a New Zealand Hospital on 21st. I went to No 2 A Stationery hospital El Arish on 22, to Kantarah on 24th, to No 14 A G hospital on 28th to convalescent depot. Left again May 20 for Maasca Base details, left Details 29 for Kanunis and joined my unit.

We left Kanunis for Gamlere July 3. August 11, I went to Port Said rest camp, left again August 20 for Kanunis Beach. Left Beach

September 18 for Kilo 9, left for Rafah Beach October 3, left for Gamlere October 25, left for Esan October 26. Left for Gamlere October 28, left for E Lan October 29 and Beersheba October 30.

Captured Beersheba October 31, left again November 3 for Diaree Ridge, return to Beersheba, left again on 5th and continued stunting and fighting through numerous small villages, including Luck and Bald Ridge, then moved back to Rechsong.

Left again February 16, 1918 and went to Turkish railway junction. 17th to Sacarhe, 18th to Bethlehem, 19th engagement, 20th engagement, 21st engagement and entered Jericho.

22nd left Jericho and moved back to Jerusalem and Bethlehem.

25th went to Sacarha, 26th went to Rechsong and left again March 5.

Went to Ramlegh, on 9th to Raimella, 13th to Jerusalem, left again on 19th for Jericho, at 10pm on 23rd we crossed the Jordan River into Syria, 26th went to Esalt, on April 2 left again and crossed the Jordan back to Jericho, 4th crossed back again.

Turks attacked on the morning of 11th but they lost heavily. On the morning of the 17th I left the Jordan with dysentery and went to Jerusalem. 18th to Eburou, 19th to Ludd, 20th to Elarish, 27th to Kantara.

April 29 to May 14 at G Hospital, Port Said. May 22 to Rest Camp. June 6 Base details Moascar, 18th to Jerusalem, 21st to Jordan Valley.

July 14, the German Storm Troop attacked us, were repulsed losing very heavily.

On 17th we moved back to Telatadum. 19th to Hebron, 23rd to Wadinein, left again August 19 for Letron, on 20th to Jerusalem, 21st to Teledum, 22nd to Jericho, 23rd to Jordan Valley.

September 5 to Mount of Temptation, 10th to another camp close by, 21st to Wadi, 22nd to Elsier , 23rd across the Jordan, 24th to Esalt. 25th captured Aman, 28th moved down the line about three miles.

October 24th I left with Malaria went to Aman, 28th to Jericho to Jersusalem Hospital No 1. 29th to Field Hospital , on November 4 to Gaza Hospital snd the 11th to Kantara.

Novnember13 to Moascar, 18th back to Reshong. December 18 to Estduid, 19th to Gaza, 21st to Belah, 22nd to Rafah.

January 17, 1919 got leave to go up to Jerusalem to visit the Holy City, back to Rafah on 23rd.

On March 6, 1919 to Moascar. 28th to Port Said and onto boat “Malwa”.

29th sailed and arrived at Teranto April 1, left on 2nd.

Trained through Italy and France. Some of the towns we went through were Taranti, Brindise, Fasano, Uola, Bare Locobondo, Termoli, Ancona, Faenzee, Boulogna, Modena, Alexandra, Asti, Turin, Bossbelna, Modane, Lyon, Brotteann, St Germain, Jusing, Versailles, Nalesherees, Launtes, Galliensnes, Rouen, Laharve.

Anzac Day ceremonies in this region

Wellington, Dawn Service at the Cenotaph in Cameron Park 6am after ex-service men and women assemble at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club from 5.45am to march down Swift Street.

Those attending are invited to return to the club for breakfast and to honour the Anzac Toast.

Annual March

Assemble Gisborne Street corner of Lee Street by 10.30am. The march to Cameron Park Cenotaph commences at 10.45am led by the Wellington Town Band.

At 10.55am the Hymn.

10.58am official welcome by Council representative.11am Laying of Wreaths. – Wellington Town Band plays musical interlude.

11.22am Anzac Day Address.

11.30am The Ode – Bugler sounds Last Post. Guides raise flag during Reveille.

11.33am Hymn. 11.40am Recessional

11.50am Closing Prayer.

11.55 National Anthem, dismissal.

3.15pm. Lowering of the Flag – all

ex-service men and women fall in at Cenotaph at 3.10pm.

STUART TOWN

March from Railway to Memorial Gates 11am to 12.30pm

MUMBIL

Service at Hall 9am to 10am.

GOLLAN

Service at Hall 11am to 12pm

GEURIE

March from Public School to Memorial at Hall 9am to 10am.

YEOVAL

Dawn Service Marchers assemble outside Royal Hotel 5.30am then March to Memorial Hall for 6am Service. Main Service starts at 10.45 at Memorial Hall after March.

OBLEY

Breakfast Service 6.45am Obley War Memorial on Gundongs Road.

Check with locals to confirm times.

keirle's
pharmacy



alliance
PHARMACY

where local health matters

**In honour of Anzac Day
Keirles Pharmacy will be closed
Saturday 25th April
reopen
Monday 27th April
9-12pm**

We stand with our community in
gratitude for the brave servicemen
and women who have defended our
freedoms
Thank you for your service

Lest we forget

31 Nanima Crescent, Wellington
02 6845 2059

email:keirles@alliancepharmacy.com.au * Check us out on facebook

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

P	S	S
	W	I
R	L	Y
	R	L
S	N	E

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

ELAS

SSUD

ERNK

TAED

There may be more than one possible answer.

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

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11x5 CROSSMATH

12 THURSDAY, APRIL 16, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

17-04-26 | PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © pagemasters.

 TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 The World This Week. 11.00 Compass. 11.30 Songs Of Praise. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 Landline. 1.30 Gardening Australia. 2.30 The Piano. 3.20 Judgment: Cases That Changed Australia. 4.10 Grand Designs. 5.00 Back Roads. 5.30 Fake Or Fortune? Final. 6.30 Compass. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 The Piano. Final. 8.25 Can You Keep A Secret? Final. 8.55 Frauds. Final. 9.40 Blue Murder Motel. 10.30 Top End Bub. 10.55 MOVIE: Two Hands. (1999) 12.25 Late Programs.	 two 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 South Aussie With Cosi. 2.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 3.30 The Yorkshire Vet. 4.30 Australia's Big Backyards. 5.30 The Aussie Property Flippers. 6.30 Escape To The Country. 7.30 The Coroner. 8.30 Vera. 10.30 Miss Scarlet And The Duke. 11.30 Late Programs.	 Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.40 You Can't Ask That. 3.00 A Bite To Eat. 3.30 QI. 4.00 Would I Lie To You? 4.30 MythBusters. 5.25 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 6.10 Grand Designs. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Wild Isles. 9.30 The Piano. Final. 10.25 Late Programs.
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 TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Landline. 2.00 Tonight At The Museum. 2.30 Back Roads. 2.55 Grand Designs Transformations. 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.40 Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Australian Story. 8.30 Four Corners. 9.15 Media Watch. 9.35 Planet America. 10.05 Foreign Correspondent. 10.55 ABC Late News. 11.10 The Business. 11.25 Late Programs.	 mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Supercars C'ship. ITM Christchurch Super 440. H'lights. 4.30 American Resto. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. 8.30 Aussie Gold Hunters. 9.30 Adventure Gold Diggers. 10.30 Late Programs.	 Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 2.15 ER. 3.00 QI. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.00 MythBusters. 4.50 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.40 Grand Designs. 6.30 Richard Osman's House Of Games Night. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 The Outlaws. 9.30 Elementary. 10.15 Late Programs.
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 TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Death In Paradise. 2.00 ANZAC Battlefields. 2.55 Grand Designs Transformations. 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.40 Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 7.55 Foreign Correspondent. 8.40 Judgment: Cases That Changed Australia. 9.30 You Can't Ask That. 10.00 Compass. 10.30 ABC Late News. 10.45 The Business. 11.00 Four Corners. 11.50 Late Programs.	 two 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Escape To The Country. 2.00 Creek To Coast. 2.30 House Of Wellness. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Call The Midwife. 8.45 Inspector Morse. 11.05 Escape To The Country. 12.05 Late Programs.	 Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.00 MythBusters. 4.50 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.40 Grand Designs. 6.30 House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Small Town Scandal. 8.55 Can You Keep A Secret? 9.25 Elementary. 10.05 Late Programs.
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 TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 News. 12.30 Press Club. 1.35 Media Watch. 1.50 ANZAC Battlefields. 2.55 Grand Designs Transformations. 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.40 Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Tonight At The Museum. Final. 8.30 The Weekly With Charlie Pickering. Final. 9.00 Can You Keep A Secret? Final. 9.30 QI. 10.00 Planet America. 10.30 ABC Late News. 10.45 The Business. 11.35 Late Programs.	 two 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Sydney Weekender. 2.30 House Calls To The Rescue. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Rookies. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Heartbeat. 8.45 McDonald And Dodds. 10.45 Air Crash Investigations. 11.45 Late Programs.	 Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.15 ER. 3.00 QI. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.00 MythBusters. 4.50 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. 5.40 Grand Designs. 6.30 Richard Osman's House Of Games Night. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Death In Paradise. 9.30 Elementary. 10.15 Late Programs.
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 7 6.00 NBC Today. 7.00 Weekend Sunrise. 10.00 The Morning Show: Weekend. 12.00 Sunday Footy Feast. 2.30 House Of Wellness. 3.30 Border Security: International. 4.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.00 Seven News At 5. 5.30 Sydney Weekender. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 The 1% Club. Return. 8.00 7NEWS Spotlight. Return. 9.00 Abused By Mum: The Ruby Franke Scandal. 10.30 24 Hours In Police Custody. 11.30 Autopsy USA. 12.30 Late Programs.	 mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Charter Boat Wars 2: Port Phillip Bay. New. 2.30 AFL Pre-Game Show. 3.00 Football. AFL. Melbourne v Brisbane. 6.00 Border Security: International. 7.00 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 8.30 MOVIE: Die Hard. (1988) Bruce Willis. 11.15 Late Programs.	 Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 3.30 MOVIE: Tummy Tom 2: A New Friend For Tummy Tom. (2024) 4.30 Kids' Programs. 6.05 Knee High Spies. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 7.05 Let's Go Bananas! 7.30 The Incestigators. 7.45 Caper Crew. 8.05 Secrets At Red Rocks. 8.30 Animal Park. 10.00 Secrets Of The Zoo. 10.45 Late Programs.
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 7 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.10 Blankety Blank. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 Glenn And Mick's Celebrity Intervention. New. 8.40 9-11. 9.40 The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. 10.40 The Agenda Setters. 11.40 St. Denis Medical. 12.10 Secrets Of Prince Andrew. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.	 mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Supercars C'ship. ITM American Resto. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. 8.30 Aussie Gold Hunters. 9.30 Adventure Gold Diggers. 10.30 Late Programs.	 Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 10.35 Kids' Programs. 5.20 Stan & Gran. 6.05 Spidey And His Amazing Friends. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Young Sheldon. 8.25 Young Sheldon. 8.45 Gladiators UK. 9.45 Kids BBQ Championship. 10.25 Kids Baking Championship. 11.05 Late Programs.
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 7 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.10 Blankety Blank. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 My Reno Rules. New. 9.15 House Of Wellness. 10.15 The Agenda Setters. 11.15 Ambulance: Code Red. 12.15 Secrets Of Prince Andrew. 2.30 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.	 mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Adventure Gold Diggers. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 Outback Truckers. 8.30 Cape Carnage: Killer Catch. 9.30 Outback Truckers. 10.30 Railroad Australia. 11.30 Late Programs.	 Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 10.35 Kids' Programs. 5.20 Stan & Gran. 6.05 Spidey And His Amazing Friends. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Young Sheldon. 8.25 Young Sheldon. 8.45 The Slow Mo Guys' Big Adventures. 9.05 MythBusters "There's Your Problem!". 9.30 BattleBots. 10.20 Merlin. 11.00 Late Programs.
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 7 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.10 Blankety Blank. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 My Reno Rules. 9.15 The Front Bar . 10.15 To Be Advised. 11.25 The Agenda Setters. 12.25 No Holds Barred: GWS Giants. 1.45 Kochie's Business Builders. 2.30 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.	 mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.30 Pawn Stars. 1.30 Outback Truckers. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 Highway Patrol. 8.30 The Force: Behind The Line. 9.30 Caught On Dashcam. 10.30 World's Wildest Police Videos. 11.30 Late Programs.	 Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 10.35 Kids' Programs. 5.20 Stan & Gran. 6.05 Spidey And His Amazing Friends. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.00 Young Sheldon. 8.25 Young Sheldon. 9.05 Adventure Time. 9.50 Pokémon: Diamond And Pearl. 10.15 My Adventures With Superman. 10.35 Late Programs.
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 9 6.00 Hello SA. 6.30 A Current Affair. 7.00 Weekend Today. 10.00 Wide World Of Sports. 11.00 NRL Sunday Footy Show. 1.00 Drive TV: Drive Car Of The Year. 1.30 Reel Destinations. 2.00 Oz Off Road TV. 3.00 Rugby League. NRL. Round 7. Parramatta Eels v Canterbury Bulldogs. 6.00 9News Sunday. 7.00 The Floor. Return. 8.15 60 Minutes. 9.15 Australian Crime Stories: The Investigators. 10.20 9News Late. 10.50 The First 48. 11.45 A Killer Makes A Call. 12.35 Oz Off Road TV. 1.30 Late Programs.	 fliX 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 My Kitchen Rules New Zealand. 12.00 My Asian Banquet. 12.30 Home And Away. 2.30 Australian Idol. Final. 4.15 Animals Aboard With Dr Harry. 5.00 Behave Yourself. 6.00 Puppy School. 6.30 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. 7.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs.	 NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 ABC News. 2.30 Aust Story. 3.00 ABC News. 3.30 Offsiders. 4.00 Landline. 5.00 ABC News With Auslan. 5.30 News Regional. 6.00 Evening News. 6.15 Foreign Correspondent. 7.00 National News. 7.30 Insiders. 8.35 If You're Listening. 9.00 ABC Nightly News. 9.30 Australian Story. 10.00 Late Programs.
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 9 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 The Floor. 1.15 Getaway. 1.45 Innovation Nation. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 The Floor. 8.45 100% Footy. 9.45 9News Late. 10.15 Outback Opal Hunters. 11.15 Footy Classified. 12.15 Tipping Point. 1.05 Hello SA. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Global Shop. 3.00 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Late Programs.	 fliX 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 The Amazing Race. 3.15 Wife Swap Australia. 4.30 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Law & Order. 8.30 Law & Order: Criminal Intent. 9.30 Law & Order: SVU. 10.30 Bones. 11.30 Late Programs.	 NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Planet America. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.
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 9 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 The Floor. 1.15 Destination WA. 1.45 My Way. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Travel Guides. Return. 9.00 Clarkson's Farm. 10.10 9News Late. 10.40 The Grand Tour. 12.30 Footy Classified. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Our State On A Plate. 3.00 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Late Programs.	 fliX 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 Rebel Wilson's Pooch Perfect. 2.35 Intolerant Cooks. 3.15 Wife Swap Australia. 4.30 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 CSI: New York. 8.30 CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. 9.30 CSI: Miami. 10.30 CSI: New York. 11.30 Late Programs.	 NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.15 Four Corners. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.
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 9 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 MOVIE: Love Amongst The Stars. (2022) 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Events That Changed Australia. 8.30 Outback Murder Highway. New. 9.30 The Killer Interview With Piers Morgan. 10.30 9News Late. 11.00 Freddy And The Eighth. 11.50 Tipping Point. 12.40 Pointless. 1.30 Late Programs.	 fliX 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 Rebel Wilson's Pooch Perfect. 2.30 Intolerant Cooks. 3.00 Extended Family. 3.30 Grand Crew. 4.00 Lopez Vs. Lopez. 4.30 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 House. 10.30 NCIS. 11.30 Late Programs.	 NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Australian Story. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.30 Late Programs.
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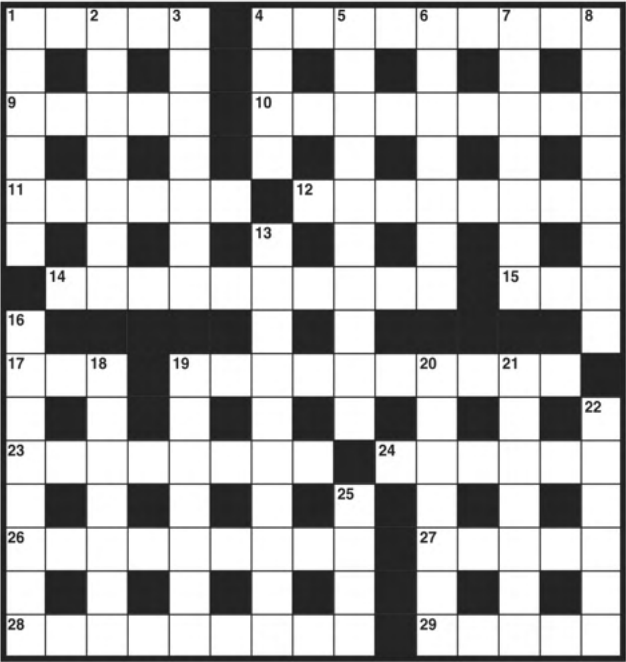
 10 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.30 My Market Kitchen. 9.00 Freshly Picked. Return. 9.30 Well Traveller. 10.00 Farm To Fork. 10.30 Everyday Gourmet. 11.00 GCBC. 11.15 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 1.00 Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. 2.00 Deal Or No Deal. 2.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 3.00 The Finish Line. 4.00 Lingo. 5.00 10 News. 6.30 10 News+. 7.00 MasterChef Australia. Return. 8.45 Race Across The World. Return. 10.00 Matlock. 11.00 NCIS: Origins. 12.00 Late Programs.	 drama 6.00 Morning Programs. 9.00 On The Fly. 9.30 Reel Action. 10.00 Navigating The World. 11.00 Escape Fishing With ET. 11.30 All 4 Adventure. 12.30 Pat Callinan's 4x4 Adventures. 1.30 JAG. 7.30 MOVIE: Mission: Impossible - Dead Reckoning. (2023) Tom Cruise. 10.30 Bull. 11.25 JAG. 12.20 Late Programs.	 Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 AFL Sunday Footy Show. 12.00 Getaway. 12.30 My Favorite Martian. 1.00 The Baron. 2.00 Edgar Wallace Mysteries. 3.15 MOVIE: They Who Dare. (1954) 5.30 Midsomer Murders. 7.30 David Attenborough's Planet Earth III. 8.40 Paramedics. 9.40 Emergency. 10.40 Major Crimes. 11.40 Late Programs.
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 10 6.00 Morning Programs. 7.30 GCBC. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.15 MasterChef Aust. 12.00 GCBC. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 MasterChef Australia. 8.40 Gogglebox Australia. 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 10 News+. 11.10 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 12.00 Late Programs.	 drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Home Shopping.	 Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 David Attenborough's Planet Earth III. 1.00 Midsomer Murders. 3.00 Antiques Roadshow. 3.30 MOVIE: Carry On Cleo. (1964) 5.30 Secret Life Of The Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Death In Paradise. 8.40 A Remarkable Place To Die. 10.40 Borderline. 11.40 Late Programs.
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 10 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.20 MasterChef Aust. 11.30 My Market Kitchen. 12.00 GCBC. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 MasterChef Australia. 8.40 The Cheap Seats. Return. 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 10 News+. 11.10 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 12.00 Late Programs.	 drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Home Shopping.	 Gem 6.00 Morning Programs.
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CROSSWORD

No. 173



ACROSS

- 1 Remains (5)

4 Artworks (9)

9 System of principles (5)

10 Soaked (9)

11 Not mature (6)
- 12 Haughty (8)

14 Unfaithful (9)

15 Pride (3)

17 Buffoon (3)

19 Capable of returning profit (10)

23 Number comprehension (8)

- 24 Computer network linking newsgroups (6)
- 26 Items of great worth (9)
- 27 Seance board (5)
- 28 At least (coll) (9)
- 29 Fashion (5)

DOWN

- 1 Salt (7)
- 2 Steamed (7)
- 3 Surgeon's instrument (7)
- 4 Sit for an artist (4)
- 5 Gate-crasher (10)
- 6 Fears (7)
- 7 A salt or ester of nitric acid (7)
- 8 Insurrection (8)
- 13 A thin noodle (10)
- 16 Circus (8)
- 18 Country in Horn of Africa (7)
- 19 Dried fruit (7)
- 20 Traditions (7)
- 21 Yearly payment (7)
- 22 Lolling (2,4)
- 25 Island (4)

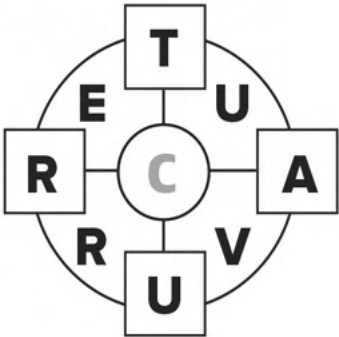


9-LETTER

No. 173

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

Today's Aim:
17 words: Good
26 words: Very good
35 words: Excellent

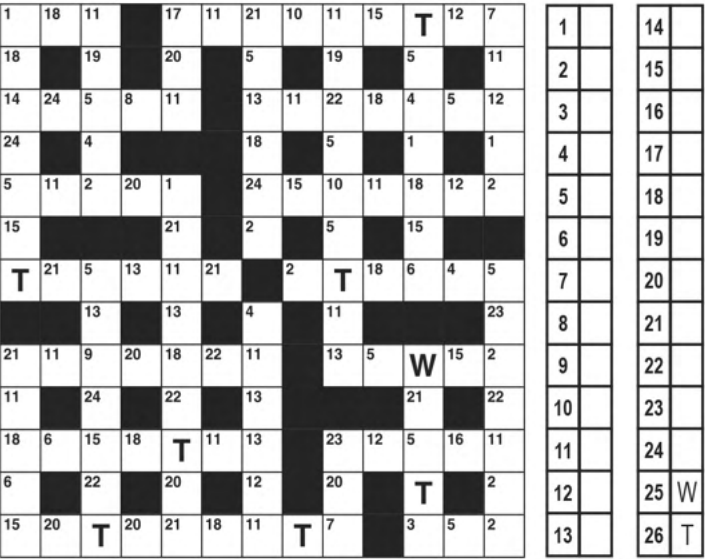


acres, acute, care, caret, care, carter, cater, carve, crater, crater, crave, crate, cruet, curate, cure, curt, CURVATURE, curve, cute, cutter, ecrin, eruct, race, race, read, recta, rectus, trace, tracer, trace, verruca

CODEWORD

No. 123

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

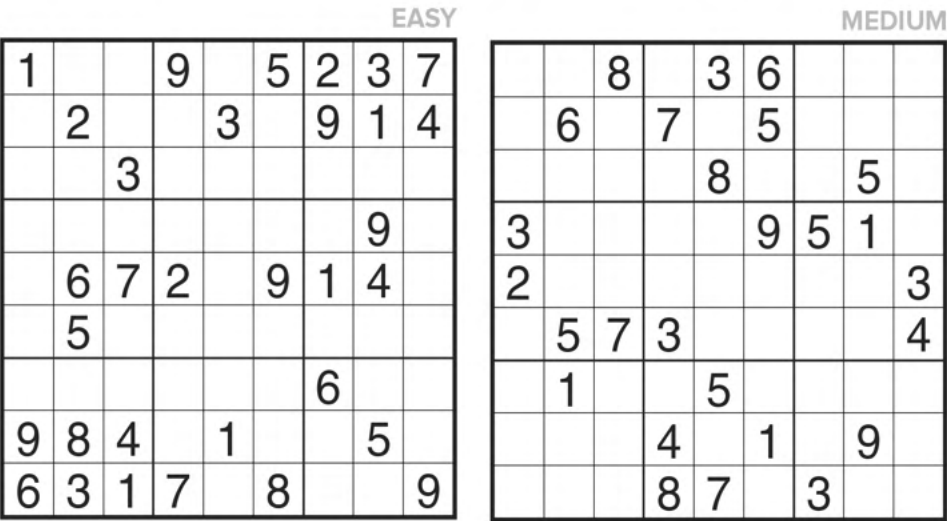


13=D, 14=A, 15=N, 16=Z, 17=F, 18=I, 19=X, 20=O, 21=R, 22=S, 23=C, 24=U, 25=W, 26=T

SUDOKU

No. 173

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



SOLUTIONS



QUICK QUIZ

- On January 15, 1919, in which US city did a large molasses tank burst, sending a wave of molasses through the streets at an estimated 56km/h?
- Kalakaua was the last reigning king of which former country?
- When was the band Imagine Dragons (pictured) formed?
- In 1915, which two women became the first female officers to serve in the NSW police force?
- The documentary *Riding Giants* traces the origins of what sport?
- Which US online music file sharing service was shut down by a court order in March 2001?
- What is the name of a traditional Austrian woman's dress with a full skirt and close-fitting bodice?
- 'Don't Answer The Phone. Don't Open The Door. Don't Try To Escape.' was the tagline of which 1996 horror film?
- Parachutes*, released in 2000, was the first studio album by which band?
- What is a winze?



WORD SEARCH

No. 083

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- BANDICOOT

BASS

BILBY

BLACK SWAN

BUSH TURKEY

COCKATOO

DADDY LONG LEGS

DINGO

DUGONG

DUNNART

ECHIDNA
- FAIRYWREN

GALAH

GOANNA

GOULDIAN FINCH

HUNTSMAN

KANGAROO

KOALA

MAGPIE

MULGA

NUMBAT

PELICAN

POSSUM

QUOKKA
- ROSELLA

STONEFISH

SWIFT

PARROT

TAIPAN

WOMBAT

WOYLIE

SECRET MESSAGE: Give me a home amongst the gumtrees

'ONE STOP SHOP' DIRECTORY

Raine&Horne.
Rural

2022 TOP THREE
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AUSTRALIA WIDE

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Contact: Sharon 0407 935 998 - Email: sharon@wdleader.news



AGRI TOPICS

Information for the
Man on the Land

**For More Information
call**



Mb: 0428 635 994

TYPICAL AUTUMN week with tops of 27 degrees and lows to 3 with no rain of any consequence and a chance of 2-4mm on a couple of days.

This dry is getting very serious for this region with most properties now hand feeding whilst cattle numbers are being reduced because of the dry.

My wife and I are back from a short break over Easter catching up with my two Victorian daughters and their families which was great.

We stayed in Port Fairy which had a strong very chilly wind blowing in from, Antarctica.

The local fisherman said the fish weren't biting due to the huge full, bright Easter moon which they say frightens the fish so they go deep in the waters to escape whether this is right I don't know, perhaps one of my readers might inform me whether this right?

Medium cray's were \$40 on Thursday, slightly bigger cray's were \$90 on Saturday.

After a very dry summer most of Victoria has had great rains and were stubble burning.

Sowing will commence around Anzac Day.

A new herbicide mix giving great results is Marathon plus Quadrant. This mix controls Amsinckia, bedstraw, bifera, bindweed, cape-weed, charlock, chickweed, cleavers, common peppergrass, corn gromwell, cow vine, dead nettle, dock, three cornered jack, fathen, fireweed, fumitory, Indian hedge mustard, amatriciana, mexican poppy, mintweed, mountain sorrel, prickly lettuce, patterson curse, rough poppy, saffron thistle, shepherd's purse, skeleton weed, sow thistle, statice, toad rush plus more.

Marathon can be mixed with lve mcpa570, also bronco400, as well as lve mcpa 570 plus priority.

Marathon may not yet be available.

ALWAYS READ THE LABEL BEFORE USE.

Markets and a glance

WOOL. No sale to report due to Easter break. 37,000 bales rostered for this week.

CATTLE. CTXL 7th. 1523, down 619. Quality mostly plain, large supplies of lightweight suitable for restockers. Young trade cattle firm, prime yearling steers 450c to 470c, heifers 420c to 473c/kg, Feeder steers back 8c, 420c to 515c, heifers dearer on medium weights, 410c to 471c/kg. Light steers to restockers to 530c, heifers to 430c. Grown cattle firm, heavy steers 430c to 459c, heavy heifers 400 to 468c/kg Cows 2 and 3 scores 290c to 365c, heavy cows to 380c/kg, heavy bulls to 390c/kg.

SHEEP. CTLX. 6782 comprising 4617 lambs. Lightweight processing lambs to 18kg \$184 to \$240. Trade 20 to 24kg \$5 cheaper, \$260 to \$296. Heavy lambs to 30kg \$296 to \$344. Extra heavy over 30kg reached \$341. Heavy hoggets reached \$275. Mutton firm.

STOCK CLEARANCE CONTINUES
Contact Michael 0428 635 994



Plasto & Company

Livestock and Property

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE. 7700 yarded. It was a mostly plain yarding, large numbers of cows, some in store condition, very large numbers of weaners suitable for the restockers. Limited numbers of prime young cattle to suit the feeders. Young trade cattle firm, vealers and yearlings 362c to 500c/kg. Feeder steers firm to 5c dearer, best heifers close to firm, most though up to 20c/kg cheaper. Feeder steers 380c to 529c, heifers 316c to 484c/kg. Young restocker cattle 50c cheaper, most young steers still sold to 536c/kg. Young restocker heifers to 438c/kg. Few grown steers up to 20c cheaper, heifers 3c/kg cheaper. Grown steers 400c to 470c, heifers 400c to 466c/kg. Cows to processors 4c to 6 cheaper. Two and 3 score cows 190c to 345c, heavy weights 350c to 387c, ave 365c/kg. Cows to restockers 10c dearer, 155c to 346c/kg. Heavy bulls to 400c/kg.

DUBBO LAMBS. The first sale for a fortnight, 28,400 lambs. Fair to good quality, good numbers of trade and heavy weight lambs. Good numbers of lighter lambs to suit restockers and feeders. Full field of buyers with additional restocker support from the south. Light lambs to restockers, very strong competition with crossbreds and Dorpers going back paddock \$110 to \$280. Merino lambs to restockers \$69 to \$215. Trade lambs \$15 to \$20 dearer, 20kg to 24kg \$230 to \$315, ave 1180c and 1230c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$20 dearer, 24kg to 30kg \$283 to \$369, ave 1180c and 1215c/kg cwt. Lambs over 30kg to \$412. Merino lambs keenly sought, trade weight Merinos \$190 to \$297, heavy weights to \$326. Hoggets to \$300.

MUTTON. Some good sheep along with plenty of plainer types. 11,300 head. Most grades firm to \$6 dearer. Merino ewes \$80 to \$310, crossbred ewes \$144 to \$326. Crossbred wethers to \$322, most sheep ave 800c and 900c/kg cwt.

STORE CATTLE. CTLX blue ribbon weaner sale 7209 yarded. Majority Angus and Angus X, weights ave 260kg to 320kg. Smaller number of buyers, competition strong amongst feeders and backgrounders. As dry conditions continue, prices were softer on both steers and heifers. Weaner steers ave 530c to 570c, lightweights under 200kg \$720 to \$1170, topping at 612c/kg. Medium weights 200kg to 330kg \$1040 to \$1820, heavy weights over 330kg \$1750 to \$2120. Feeder steers reached \$2250, ave 530c/kg. Weaner heifers 430c to 450c, lightweights \$630 to \$845, reaching 477c/kg. Medium weights \$810 to \$1435, heavy weaner heifers \$1500 to \$1700.

WOOL. No report this week – Easter break.

AWI's new CEO

Australian Wool Innovation has appointed Bryan Fry as its new Chief Executive Officer.

The appointment follows the resignation of John Roberts.

Bryan Fry brings a unique combination of international leadership experience, a strong understanding of agriculture, and deep expertise in global marketing and brand development.

AWI chairman George Millington said Mr Fry's background positions him well to lead AWI into its next phase, with a continued focus on strengthening demand for Australian wool and delivering value for levy payers.

"The Board is delighted to have Bryan join AWI and we look forward to working closely with him in the years ahead," Mr Middleton said.

"We are confident that his leadership will build on the strong foundations in place and continue to support a vibrant and sustainable future for the wool industry."

In acknowledging John Robert's contribution to the company and the broader wool industry, Mr Millington sincerely thanked him for his leadership, dedication and commitment throughout his tenure.

"Over his time as CEO, John had made a significant and lasting contribution to AWI and to the wool industry more broadly in a career that has spanned nearly four decades," he said.

"He has led the organisation through a period of considerable change and challenge, maintaining a clear focus on delivering value for



Bryan Fry, AWI's new CEO.

woolgrowers while strengthening AWI's position both domestically and internationally.

"Under John's leadership, AWI has continued to invest in and promote the global demand for Australian wool, supporting key marketing and brand initiatives that have reinforced wool's position as a natural, sustainable and premium fibre.

"He has also played an important role in fostering strong relationships across the supply chain and with key industry stakeholders, ensuring collaboration and alignment in progressing shared industry priorities.

"John's tenure has also seen a continued focus on research, development and innovation, supporting productivity, animal welfare and sustainability outcomes for woolgrowers.

"His steady and considered leadership, coupled with his deep commitment to the industry, has been instrumental in guiding AWI through both opportunities and challenges, and positioning the organisation well for the future."

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Grenfell Picnics

REARED ON the family farm at Tumbarumba before becoming a teacher at Estella Primary School in Wagga Wagga, Emily Waters, with a top ride on Saturday, won the 1400 metres the Overall Drilling & CCC Parts-Grenfell Picnic Cup.

Apart from her regular employment and other interests, Emily Waters rides trackwork for Wagga Wagga trainer Scott Spackman and they combined to win the Cup with Ozzy The Equaliser.

Sunroe led the eight-horse Cup field until Ozzy The Equaliser (\$3.80) burst through the pack to score in a close finish from Sunroe (Ricky Blewitt, \$5) and Individualist (Leandro Ribeiro, \$4.60).

Emily Waters had started the day on a bright note when winning the feature sprint race, the 1000m CL Commodities-Picnic Bracelet on Cassimir which is trained at Tumbarumba by her father Mont Waters.

After enjoying a nice run in third position, Cassimir (\$3.60) sprinted along the inside rail to win by a length from the leader Artieos (Dylan Parrott, \$2.20 favourite) and Callie Cool (Leandro Ribeiro, \$2.40).

Making it three wins from the last four starts, the Connie Greig, Dubbo trained Maryland Bridge (Leandro Ribeiro, \$2.80) worked home strongly from last early to beat the leader Friskee Frog (Ashley Boyd, \$1.80 fav) and Rita Red (Ricky Blewitt, \$3) in the 1200m Whitbuild Class 2 Trophy Handicap.

Another to produce a big finish from the tail of the field was the Merv Rumble, Dubbo trained Kiltiki (Ricky Blewitt, \$2.80 fav) when beating Rogue Hero (Rebecca McRae, \$7) and the Victorian trained The Village Fox (Tamsin Gough, \$4.40) in the 1400m Evolution Mining-Conditional Picnic Handicap.

Accomplished horsewoman Sarah McIlrick from Alectown won the 1200m Mawhood Grenfell IGA Maiden Plate with Epic Statement (Ashley Boyd, \$4.60) which led throughout to score by a length from Lucky Monkey (Paul Zerafa, \$2) and Bold Bender (Leandro Ribeiro, \$4.20 fav).

Highly successful Wagga Wagga trainer Tim Donnelly won the longest race on the Picnic circuit, the 2150m McAllister Motors Class 2 Trophy Handicap with Vogelle.

Bessie Dimery brought Vogelle (\$2.80 equal fav) with a well-timed run to tackle the leaders in the straight before moving clear to win by two lengths from The Bentley (Leandro Ribeiro, \$2.80) and Testing The Cugat (Ricky Blewitt, \$3.40).

Grenfell attracted a very good crowd and trainers who travelled from as far afield as Seymour in Victoria were appreciative of the many bonuses they received and the excellent turf track prepared for the meeting.

Orange Cup on Friday followed on Saturday by Tomingley Picnics and the Queen Of The West meeting at Dubbo.



Wellington Race Club

Become a member of Wellington Race Club
Just \$66 includes you and a guest to all race meetings.
Wellington Race Club
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Wellington Public School

KINDER



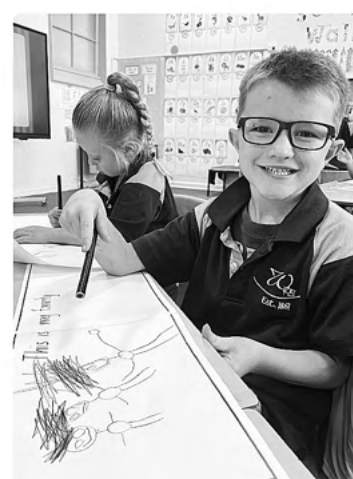
Mrs Drew and her hardworking team of Kindergarten students are under this week's spotlight. The Monday morning routine for Kinder Green begins with the Whole School Assembly followed by Literacy. Today's schedule included activities with a goal focus on letter/sound knowledge development, blending simple words and working as part of a team.

Mrs Drew went through each activity station with the students so that they were familiar with what was expected. Students then worked in groups of four and rotated around a variety of activities that addressed these learning goals. Some activities were assisted by Miss Sissy and Mrs Drew and others relied on students managing their activity as a student group.

Not only are students developing literacy focus areas but they are also learning from each other, taking turns, complimenting each other on efforts and listening to instructions.

It was also beautiful to hear that several students dream of being librarians, authors and illustrators when they are older.

Thank you to Mrs Drew, Miss Sissy and Kinder Green for allowing us into your wonderful classroom.



Pracey-Holmes reclaims Jockey Challenge trophy

LOCAL JOCKEY Jake Pracey-Holmes was determined to retake the Jockey Challenge trophy at this year’s Wellington Boot Racing Carnival. And he did just that last Sunday scoring 13 points, the same total he won the trophy with in it’s inaugural year two years ago. The Clerk of the Scales – Nigel Tolhurst Memorial Trophy was initiated by Nigel’s wife after his passing from cancer three years ago. Up to his death, Nigel Tolhurst was Clerk of the Scales at numerous race meeting throughout the Central and Western Districts and is fondly remembered by the dozens of jockeys he weighed before and after their race. He also worked on the Wellington race-course for Wellington Race Club as assistant groundsman for a long period. This year, Jake Pracey-Jones gained 13 points from wins and placing in the

challenge competition. Runner-up this year was Jacob Stiff while Braith Nock, who was place second last year, came third. Sharon Tolhurst said she and Nigel believed jockeys played an integral role in racing. “They are praised and cursed, depending on the success of their ride, but there would not be a racing industry without them,” Sharon said. “I will continue to sponsor this challenge and promote the role of jockeys and their importance to this racing industry.” Prizemoney tallied \$3500, a purse worth riding for. Points are awarded for the three placings in each of the 16 races run during the annual Wellington Boot two-day racing carnival, and the best three jockeys take home a share of the purse.



Jockey Challenge winner for the second time in three years, Jake Pracey-Holmes with Nigel Tolhurst’s grand-daughter Halle and her mother Jasmine.



The 2026 Wellington Boot Tooheys Guys and Dolls Challenger with competition organisers Sharon Wilson of *Wellington & District Leader* (left) and Jane Angelini representing the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club (far right).



Banjo Patterson comes to life (imaginary) in 90-minute performance

THE ‘Life & Rhymes of Banjo Paterson’ show performed by Gregory North will be conducted at the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club auditorium next Sunday, April 19 and there are some tickets left. The performance gives a thorough insight into the fascinating life of a great Australian whose influence is still felt today. “There are some wonderful images to accompany the show and I look forward to bringing his poems to life on the stage,” Gregory North told the *“Leader”*. Banjo’s humour still entertains and reminds us of what it is to be Australian. This will be nostalgic for anyone who has heard or read a Banjo Paterson poem. “There’s a wide variety of his poetry presented in the show which gives an

idea of the diversity of his subjects and moods and the adventures he experienced during his rich life. “I hope that younger people will come along to see what the fuss is about too and be turned on to the fun of Banjo’s words”. Banjo Paterson was, of course, famous for the creation of bush ballads *Waltzing Matilda* and *The Man from Snowy River* and on the 19th September, 1901 presented a lecture on the Boer War in Wellington. With the 125th anniversary of this historic tour, Gregory North, three-times Australian champion bush poet, will give a tribute to Banjo Paterson’s visit when he performs his 90-minute show. The show will be a mix of stories, songs

and poetry that will bring Paterson’s strong connection to the bush and its characters to life. He said poetry was meant to be heard and hopes his use of voices and actions enhance Banjo’s words and bring back memories for audience members. The *Life & Rhymes of Banjo Paterson* will be performed at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club at 2pm on Sunday, April 19. Tickets are \$30 for Adults and \$20 for Children under 16. Tickets can be purchased online at [123tix.com.au](https://www.123tix.com.au) or at the DOOR (if not sold-out prior). For group tickets or any further information contact Julie Hancock on 0412 909 490.



Battery warning after Gulgong blaze

From ABC Western Plains

A LITHIUM-ION battery that was charging in a device is suspected of igniting a house fire near Gulgong on March 28. Teams from Fire and Rescue NSW and the NSW Rural Fire Service responded to reports of the blaze around 3pm, arriving to a house well alight on the Castlereagh Highway west of Gulgong. Fire and Rescue said the fire was quickly brought under control, but unfortunately “very little was able to be saved”. Investigations are ongoing.

Media research proves local news matters

RESEARCH CONTINUES to reinforce what regional communities already know - Local news matters. A major national study led by Deakin University, in partnership with Country Press Australia, surveyed more than 4000 local news readers, one of the largest studies of its kind in Australia. The findings were clear. Local newspapers play a critical role in:

- Building community connection
- Supporting a sense of place and identity
- Providing reliable, trusted information

In fact, research consistently shows regional Australians place strong trust in their local news sources, especially compared to broader media. At a time when global platforms are reshaping the media landscape, that local connection has never been more important. Country Press Australia is proud to represent publishers like the *Wellington & District Leader* who continue to deliver trusted, community-focused journalism every week.

Binjang tea brews national success

WELLINGTON-BASED Indigenous tea company has brewed some winning blends to take out top honours at one of the country’s premier tea competitions - the Golden Leaf Awards.

Proudly supported by the NSW Government, Binjang Tea has cemented its reputation across the Central West and beyond for turning its blend of Australian native ingredients into unique recipes.

Wiradjuri woman Megan Humphries started the company at her Wellington home in the Binjang Valley.

Together with her business partner, Nadine Runciman, she has grown it into the successful brand it is today offering a range of unique tea blends, curated hampers and immersive native tea experience workshops.

A cup of Binjang Tea can also now be enjoyed by travellers in the Qantas Chairman’s and First Class lounges.

The pair were honoured to receive four medals including three gold and a silver.

“This is more than just recognition for Binjang Tea, it celebrates the unique and soul-stirring tastes of Australian native botanicals and showcases the global excellence of Indigenous innovation,” Ms Humphries said.

Acting Executive Director of the Regional Economic Development Network, Craig Jenkins congratulated the Binjang Tea team for its accomplishment.

“This achievement reflects the remarkable creativity, skill, cultural knowledge and hard work displayed by Megan and Nadine,” he said.

“Binjang Tea’s national recognition is a testament to the pride they take in sharing Aboriginal culture with communities

across the Central West and the country. “The State Government is committed to supporting initiatives that help Aboriginal businesses like Binjang Tea grow, innovate and reach new markets.

“Megan and Nadine’s achievements will also inspire other emerging enterprises across the region.”

Binjang Tea was awarded Gold in the Chai, Herbal Australiana and Green tea categories with its Binjang Bush Chai, Binjang Bush Green and Binjang Bush Lemon Myrtle and Ginger.

It also claimed Silver in the Herbal – Loose Blend (Unflavoured) category with its Binjang Bush Peppermint tea.

The Golden Leaf Awards is an independent competition judged by professional cuppers to distinguish the highest quality and best tasting teas commercially available in the Australasian marketplace.



Megan Humphries and Nadine Runciman with their winning Binjang teas.

Never Late Fe-Mail Postie Bike ride

Supporting Wings4Kidz

POSTIE BIKES with a difference – more than 85 women are riding over 800km on “Postie Bikes”, in four days to raise funds for Wings4Kidz.

The tour group leaves Orange on Tuesday, April 21, travelling via Blayney, Bathurst, Sofala, Mudgee, Ballimore, Wellington and finishing at Dubbo Zoo on Friday, April 24.

This will be the event’s fourth year and this year funds should reach \$1.3 million.

Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club will be hosting the charity riders for dinner on April 23 and breakfast the next morning before their final run to Dubbo Zoo.

In the past three ride the group has raised more than \$950,000 for Wings5Kidz and hoping to raise at least another \$400,000 during this year’s ride.

Of the 85 women, this year there are two riders that were once Wings4kidz “Kidz” but have grown up to now enjoy the ride.

Also, there are seven mothers and two grandmothers of kids who have also utilised the free flight service.

The cavalcade will travel through the towns of other families that utilise the service, with the families invited to join the participants for dinners to share their stories.

Supported by mechanics to keep the bikes going, and two doctors to keep the riders ship-shape, it is a rolling group of over 100 people.

During the past three years of the Never Late Fe-Mail Postie bike ride, through the hard work of the women on the event both in fundraising and by spreading the Wings4Kidz story, the charity has grown from just over 70 rural families being supported to now over 140 families.

Australia leads the world in providing specialist care and treatment for children with serious and life-threatening illnesses, something appreciated when it is needed.

Having a child diagnosed with a serious medical condition that may require treatment for months, or several years is traumatising for the entire family, but imagine if it also meant several hours, or days of travel just to access treatment.

This could mean days, weeks or months away from home and the support of family and friends, and having to deal with long difficult treatments in isolation away from the support of partners and family.

In addition, being faced with travel and accommodation costs of thousands per week keeping the family together on top of the very significant treatment costs that families face with a seriously ill child.

For families living in regional areas, this is their reality as they face the significant and difficult challenges to access treatment for a child that is only available in the major hospitals.

Wings4Kidz is a registered charity and aims to lessen the significant burden and effect of long distance travel for these children and families by providing a specialist free air and ground transport service, and keeping these families together during their difficult journey.

Wings4Kidz aircraft are registered for commercial operation, and pilots are carefully selected for their skills and experience to ensure the highest level of safety is provided for the precious cargo.

For a child requiring specialist treatment for heart conditions, blood disorders, cancer, congenital disorders, burns treatment or the many other conditions which can only be treated at major hospitals, Wings4Kidz is there to support them throughout their treatment journey.

Long journeys by car for several hours or days, sometimes on a weekly basis, and can take several years before the treatment is complete.

This is not only stressful for the parents, but it’s also detrimental for the children



Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club is hosting the Fe-Mail riders for Wing4Kids dinner on Thursday, April 23 and Breakfast the next morning. Townspeople are invited to wave them on to Dubbo Zoo final leg of the ride on Friday morning.

both physically and emotionally as well as detrimental to their health, and has a significant impact on the family unit.

Replacing this with a comfortable one-hour flight reduces the financial stress, is safer, less fatiguing, and something the kids really look forward to.

Wings4Kidz is very proud to be 100 per cent volunteer based, meaning every cent raised from this exciting event goes to keeping our plane



Snapped at the Boot - Fashions on the Field



Line up for the Best Dressed Gentleman open section.



Judges Brooke Strahan and Maria Fourie.



Best Dressed Ladies 18-40 runner up Brianna Shuttle and winner Jess Skinner with co-judge Maria Fourie.



Best Dressed women 40 and over runner up Sarah Kelly and winner Edith Osborne



Best Dressed Junior Filly under 12 winner Sophie Finn.



Best Dressed Man open runner up Garnet Kepo and winner Kevin Frazier with co-judge Maria Fourie.



Best Dressed Local Ladies winner Caitlin Eather and runner up Kevena Unwin.



Best Dressed Junior Colt under 12 entrants Walter and Billy Mitchell.

Wellington’s young philanthropist: Audrey Burfitt raises \$1522 for Community Program

ON EASTER Monday, seven-year-old Audrey Burfitt showcased her entrepreneurial spirit and compassion by raising an impressive \$1522 through her charity cupcake store.

Set up in collaboration with her mother’s café, Jespresso, Audrey has made a significant impact in her community with this heartfelt initiative – the second year she has made, then sold her cupcakes.

The proceeds from her cupcake sales this year were generously donated to Jeff Amatto’s Darrambal Program.

This school-based initiative is dedicated to connecting students with their cultural heritage, aiming to enhance attendance and engagement in learning.

The program is uniquely adaptable, aligning with classroom goals while fostering a deep sense of cultural pride among students.

The Darrambal Program is designed to:

- Connect Students to Culture: By immersing students in their heritage, the program nurtures a strong sense of identity.
- Monitor Engagement: Continuous tracking of student progress ensures that they remain connected to their cultural roots throughout their educational journey.
- Involve Families: Regular updates keep parents and guardians informed, reinforcing learning at home.

Through these efforts, students not only gain confidence but also develop a strong voice in their communities.

They emerge as ambassadors of their culture, inspiring positive contributions and decisions that resonate beyond the classroom.

Audrey, who has previously organised similar fundraising events, expressed her motivation by stating, “I like to help



people and make others happy.”

Her dedication to philanthropy is further supported by her grandmother, Lyn Gough, and her friend, Natacha Richards, who assist her in baking the delicious cupcakes.

Jeff Amatto, the founder of the Darrambal Program, was deeply touched by Audrey’s initiative.

“She is one very kind-hearted young girl,” he said,

highlighting the profound impact of her generosity.

Audrey’s efforts exemplify the spirit of community and the importance of nurturing young leaders who are committed to making a difference.

As her charitable endeavours continue, she inspires others to engage in acts of kindness, demonstrating that even the smallest gestures can create ripples of positive change.

Sunserve apprentice diesel mechanic National Road Transport Museum inductee

FORMER WELLINGTON truckie, Barry Flanagan has been inducted to the National Road Transport Museum.

Born in Orange in May, 1947, Barry has been involved in the trucking industry for more than 50 years.

He began an diesel mechanic apprenticeship in 1964 with Sunserve Pty Ltd, Wellington, the local Massey Ferguson dealer, then moved on to Mack Trucks in 1969 where he gained a sound working knowledge of engines and trucks.

While with Mack Trucks he also started driving tankers for

Royce Pierce, transporting heating oil.

He received a wage from Mack Trucks by day and collected another wage from Roy Pierce for driving his truck after hours.

In 1970 Barry married Barbara and for their honeymoon they travelled from Sydney to Mt Isa, Queensland in a ‘B’ Model Mack when the Bourke to Mt Isa stretch was an all-dirt road.

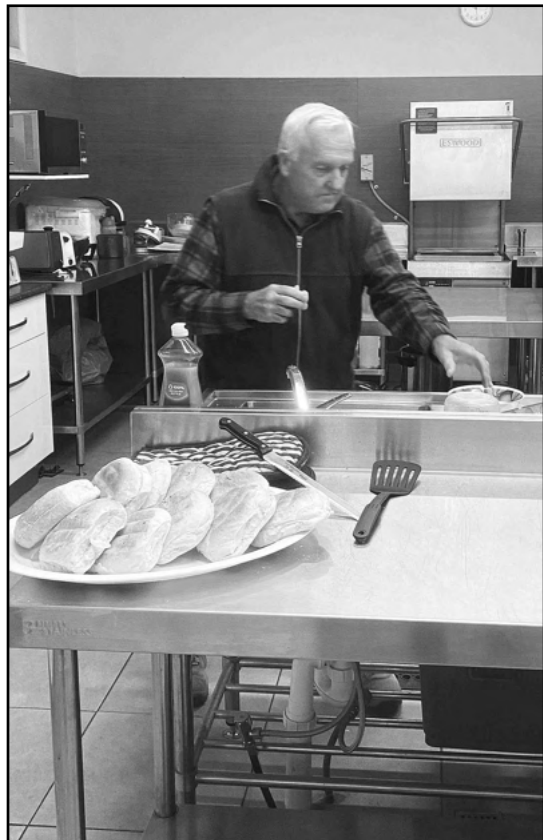
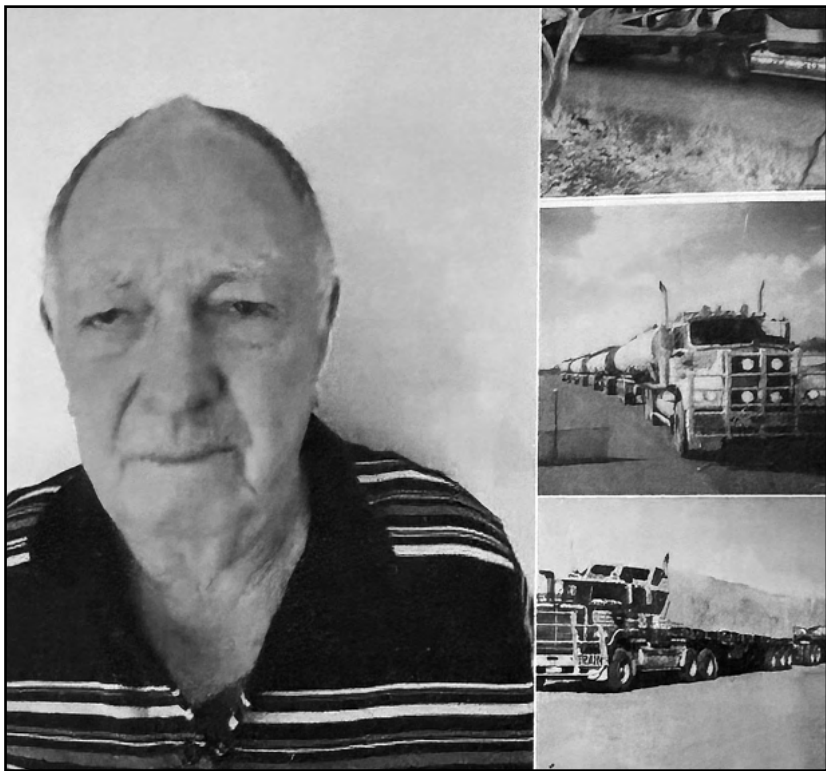
The first truck Barry purchased was an International C180 Supercharged 180HP Cummins which he replaced with a White

4000 Cummins to cart steel for BHP and general freight from Port Kemble and Newcastle to Darwin in the Northern Territory.

By 1982 he had purchased a Western Star and in 1985, had a custom-made six-foot bunk built for his son, Wade’s wheelchair.

The bunk had purpose-built ramps so the wheelchair could be driven up into the bunk.

The modification enabled Wade to travel with his dad from Wellington to Darwin during the school holidays which he thoroughly enjoyed.



Morning Tea at the Shed

BARRY COOKED up a great morning tea for the members a couple of Fridays ago, he served up egg and bacon rolls, a real treat.

All the fellows tucked in along with a cuppa and a lively discussion about fuel prices and the Middle East conflict.

So well fed and the world’s problems solved, that’s what a good morning tea can do for you.

“We do more than fix things at the Men’s Shed.”



**We take it for granted.
Until it's gone.**

**Local journalism works the same way.
It keeps communities informed,
connected and accountable.**

**Strong regional journalism is essential
infrastructure.**

The time to support it is now.

**Country Press
AUSTRALIA**

Three sides milestone for Redbacks

Wellington Redbacks Rugby Union Club - Round 1 Match Report



LAST SATURDAY 11 (April 11) was a milestone day for the Wellington Redbacks Rugby Union Club fielding three sides for the first time in a generation as the 2026 Central West Rugby Union season got underway at home against the Mudgee Wombats.

Women's XV

For the first time in two years, the Wellington Redbacks fielded a Women's XV and the girls announced their return to the competition in style. Going up against a strong Mudgee Wombats Women's side, the Redbacks were hard fought all game and went down 27-0, but the scoreline does not tell the full story. The defence was outstanding. The structure is coming together and the heart this group showed throughout was a clear sign of what is to come. This is a team that is training hard and building toward something special. The rest of the Women's competition has been put on notice.

Second Grade

For the first time in 20 years, the Wellington Redbacks fielded a second grade side, and what a way to mark the occasion. In a contest that went down to the wire, the Redbacks Second XV defeated the

defending premiers Mudgee Wombats 19-15 in a match that had the crowd on their feet right to the final whistle. The defence was relentless and the character shown in holding that lead under late pressure was a credit to every player who pulled on the jersey. It was a result that will live long in the memory of everyone who was there.

First Grade

The Firsts faced a stern test in the season opener, going down 54-5 to an excellent Mudgee Wombats outfit that will be among the competition favourites again this year. It was a tough afternoon but one that told the Redbacks exactly where the work needs to be done. This is a group that is growing and the belief within the camp remains strong. There is plenty to build on and the club is excited for what lies ahead. A massive thank you to the Mudgee Rugby Union Club for making the trip to Wellington and putting on three quality games of rugby. That is what this great competition is about. The club extends its sincere thanks to all the volunteers who gave up their time to set up, pack up, cook the barbecue and run the bar. Days like this do not happen without that



kind of effort behind the scenes. A special mention to Carmen Gain, who worked the canteen all day and captured photos throughout. The club could not have done it without her. **Next game** The Redbacks are back in action on Friday, April 24 at home at Rygate Oval for the Kapyong Day Clash.



It promises to be a very special evening, with a flag party from B Company, 1st/19th Battalion, The Royal New South Wales Regiment in attendance, we will also read the Ode and play the Last Post. Kick off times are: Women's XV at 5:30pm 2nd Grade at 6:40pm 1st Grade at 8pm. Come down, bring the family and get behind the Redbacks. **Abe Dearmer**

Mental Health forum today in Public School hall

SUICIDE PREVENTION is the topic of a Mental health Forum at Wellington Public School Hall today (Thursday, 16) from 12 midday to 4pm. With the theme of 'Our Community, People, Our Wellbeing' the program being provided by Wellington Wedgetails and WACHS will display service providers information stalls, guest speakers, a community @7A, lunch and afternoon tea. Transport is available if required. "Let's stand together, support each other and create stronger pathways forward". Contact Marsha 0437 115 847 or WACHS 02 6845 9310.

Your sport can record results in the "Sport" section.

Just contact:

mark@wdleader.news

AMPYR announces community grants of \$100,000

AMPYR AUSTRALIA has invested more than \$100,000 directly into the future of the Wellington community, supporting 15 local community organisations through its Bulabul 1 Battery Community Fund. This is the first investment of the Fund which backs grassroots projects spanning cultural heritage, youth development, energy initiatives, sport and vital community infrastructure, ensuring the benefits of the Bulabul Battery are felt well beyond construction. Grants to:- Wellington Information Neighbourhood Services to fund drop-in sessions to provide a safe space for children aged 8-17. Wellington Multi Service Centre to support volunteers, essential training, and the endofyear celebration for volunteers and clients. Wellington Touch Football Association for assistance to cover essential participation costs, upgrading sporting equipment, purchase of uniforms, registration fees and for representative teams to travel. Wiradjuri Wellington Aboriginal Town Common Aboriginal Corporation to assist in running of cultural programs, including the purchase of possum skins and installing power infrastructure. Wellington Warriors Football Club for upgrading the Senior Club's sports and training equipment.

Rotary Club of Wellington to install a solar and battery system. Wellington Police Citizens Youth Club to implement a multi-sport program that supports children aged 5-13 to build physical skills, confidence and social connection through fun, active play. Wellington Amateur Theatrical Society to upgrade lighting on stage 1. Wellington Little Athletics Club to upgrade of club sporting equipment. Burrendong Arboretum Land Management for funding the Water Management Plan. Dhubu-Gu Local Aboriginal Land Council to purchase of musical equipment and a speaker system.



Wellington Redbacks v Mudjee

Carmen Gain Photos



Golfing News

Gale and Newham double up for Boot Ambrose win

SATURDAY'S WELLINGTON Boot two-person Ambrose attracted a full field of golfers hitting the fairways coming from all over the State not only for golf, but for the annual Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club Wellington Boot two-day racing carnival.

Congratulations to Brian Gale and Mitch Newham who came away with the win in the Ambrose with a 64nett.

Runners-up were Steve Gough and John Donnelly by the barest of margins of 64.25nett.

Third prize went to Brett Lay and Neil Baker with a 64.5nett.

Nearest the pin on 8th John Donnelly, 14th Reid Armstrong, 16th John Gersbach.

NTP in two shots was taken out by Cameron Jones.

Longest drives went to Trent Forrest in A grade and Brock Naden in B grade.

Wednesday Ladies played an Individual Stableford.

Winner of the day with a great score of 40pts by Cameron McPhee. Runner-up was Kathy Martin finishing with 35pts. Prize winner was, Jannelle Frappell 33pts.

Thursday's Individual Stableford was won by Lewis Stanley who finished with 37pts. Runner-up, Rex England finished with 36pts on c/b.

Prize winners were Drew Stone 36pts, Liam Conn 35pts, Ashley Bullock 34pts on c/b.

J and B Cup Matchplay Championships Round 2 to be played by April 25.

Draw for Round 2 of the Kiss Trophy has B Kiss v W Bruce, R Baker v D O'Brien, P Neuenhaus v P West, D Bell v N Royal, B Eather v K Cusack, J Barton v C Royal, R Miller v J Gersbach, N Stanford v D Naveau, K Reid v J

Bullock or D Hyde, T Parker v D Ney or D McCullum, A Ryan v S Whiteman, E Keffe v J Ryan, J Donnelly v Wendy Slack-Smith, A Bullock v R Agar, G McNaughton v G Cusack, J Southwell v S Kiss

Matches to be finalised by Apr 18.

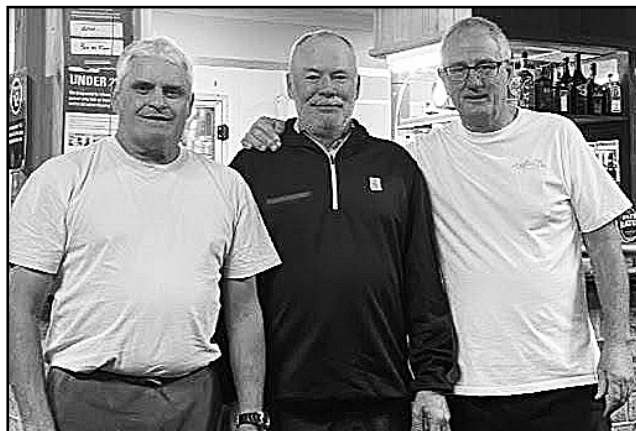
Wellington Soldiers Memorial and Golf Club Open has been set down for Sunday, May 3.

This Saturday's events are an Individual Stroke and Round 2 of the Kiss Trophy.

19th Hole



2026 Wellington Boot two-person Ambrose winners Dean Gale and Mitch Newham.



Iberdrola Twilight Thursday 9-hole competition winner Joe Ryan with organisers Rod Pedron and Garry (Mooch) McCarroll.



Iberdrola runner-up Adam Ryan with Rod Pedron and Mooch McCarroll.

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial
& Golf Club

ROCK N' MASH
Live
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SATURDAY 25TH APRIL
STARTS FROM 7.30PM

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial
& Golf Club

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WELLINGTON SOLDIERS MEMORIAL CLUB

END OF THE MONTH - TOP IT ALL OFF WITH A BANG!

HIGH ROLLERS BINGO, AND MONTHLY SPECIAL RAFFLE PRIZES!

75 ON ARTHUR RESTAURANT

KICKSTART YOUR WEEK!

Happy Hour: 4.00pm-6.30pm

MON

TUE

TERRIFIC TUESDAY!

Bingo: 7.00pm-11.00pm | Main Bar: 4.00pm-6.00pm | Draw at 7.00pm

Members Bingo Draw: 6.00pm-8.00pm (Min \$2000, Jackpots \$500 each draw)

Happy Hour: 4.00pm-6.30pm

WED

MIDWEEK FUN!

Bingo: 11.30am-11.55pm | Happy Hour: 4.00pm-6.30pm

THU

THIRSTY THURSDAY!

Bingo: 7.00pm-9.00pm | Happy Hour: 4.00pm-6.30pm

FRI

CELEBRATE THE WEEKEND!

Members Bingo Draw: 6.00pm-8.00pm (Min \$2000, Jackpots \$500 each draw)

Raffle: 8.00pm-10.00pm | Draw at 10.00pm

Cash Fever: 8.00pm-10.00pm (Min \$1000, Jackpots \$1000)

Happy Hour: 4.00pm-6.30pm

SAT

SATURDAY AFTERNOON DELIGHT:

Happy Hour: 1.30pm-5.30pm

SUN

WRAP UP THE WEEKEND!

Members Bingo Draw: 6.00pm-8.00pm (Min \$2000, Jackpots \$500)

Raffle: 8.00pm-10.00pm | Draw at 10.00pm

Cash Fever: 8.00pm-10.00pm (Min \$1000, Jackpots \$1000)

Happy Hour: 1.30pm-5.30pm

COURTESY BUS AVAILABLE FROM 6.30PM EVERY DAY, GOLD COIN DONATION, EACH WAY \$25 IF OUT OF TOWN

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OPEN: 12.30PM - 2.30PM, 4.30PM - 8.00PM

CLOSED: 10.30PM ON MONDAY AND TUESDAY | 06 772 6644 3140

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PLUS \$500 CASH!

We're giving away \$4,500 worth of appliances PLUS \$500 cash!

Just swipe your card when purchasing drinks or playing the pokies to go in the draw.

Automatic entries | Must be in the Club to win

Join now and swipe your way to a home upgrade!

Finishes 6pm Sunday 31 May

CLUBS & COMMUNITY AWARDS
Education
2021 WINNER
Wellington Soldiers Club

Gamble Help is close at hand Gambleaware.nsw.gov.au | 1800 858858 | gambleaware.nsw.gov.au

ARTHUR STREET, WELLINGTON | INFORMATION FOR MEMBERS AND THEIR GUEST

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

6845 2877

ANZAC DAY
Two-Up

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial & Golf Club

ANZAC Day 25th April 2026

Two-Up commencing at 2pm - 6pm
followed by LIVE MUSIC!

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial & Golf Club

Lest We Forget

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial
& Golf Club

MUSIC
WAZZIC

NIGEL STANLEY

SATURDAY 18TH APRIL
STARTS FROM 7.30PM

HOLIDAY
BINGO!
&
TRIVIA

Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club Auditorium

Thursday 16th April 2026

11am until 1 pm

Great prizes to be won & fun to be had!

FREE

Maree 0427636023

FUN FACT

WELLINGTON
SOLDIERS MEMORIAL CLUB

BURRO
REGIONAL
COUNCIL

MISSION
AUSTRALIA